

Unofficial Naval Combat and Campaign guidelines
for the world's greatest roleplaying game

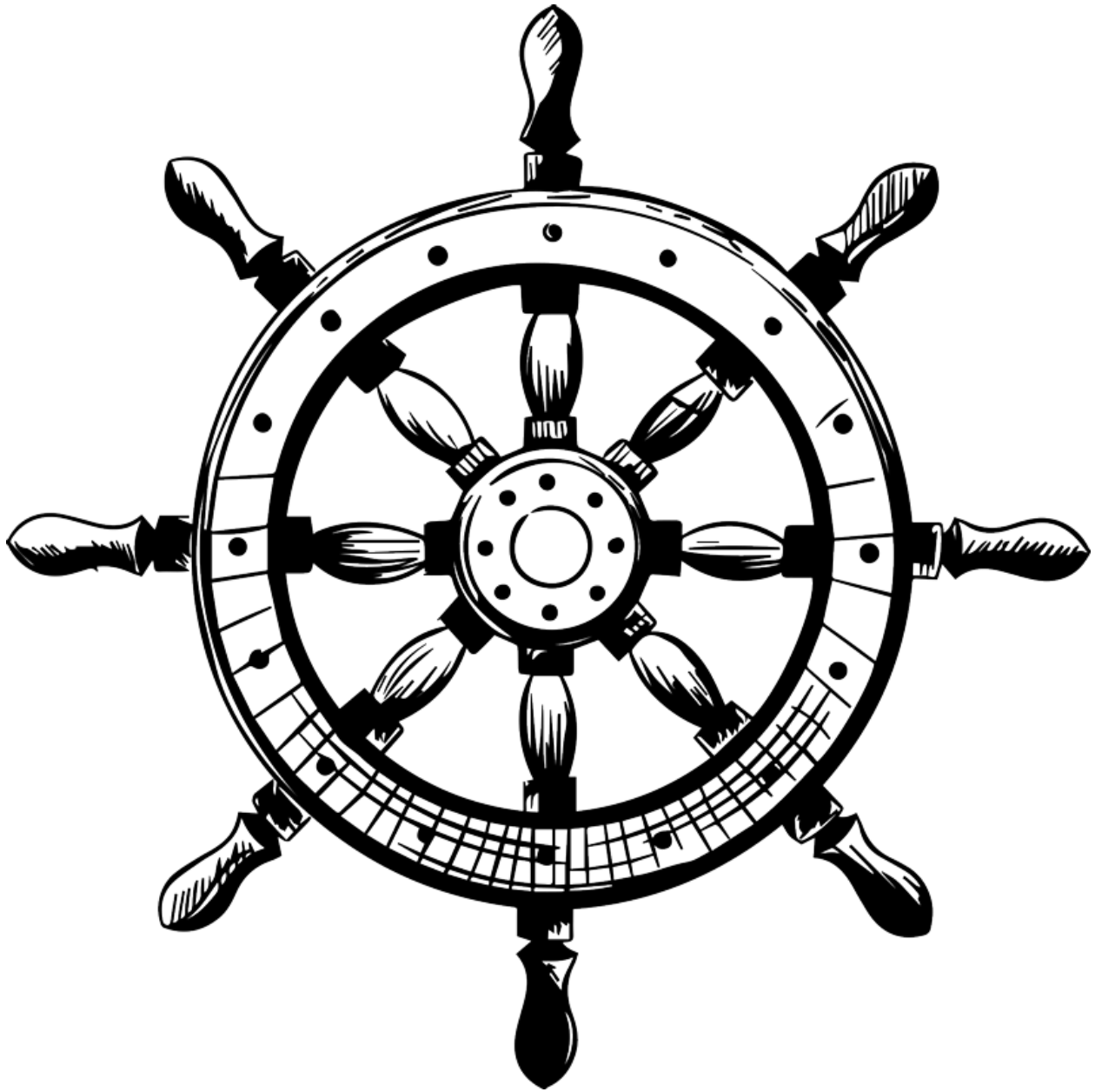
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BS_DungenMaster, v1.0

Introduction

As the schooner crested the waves, the Lookout, perched atop the highest mast, cried out a word of warning.

"Ship ahead!"

The officers rushed to the forecastle and peered out into the boiling sea. Not one could make out the vessel they were warned of.

"Friend or foe?" The Captain called up. "What flag do they fly?"

"Red background, with a white tower! Not one that I know, sir!"

The group turned to the Quartermaster, the most traveled of them. His leathery skin made a dry sound as he absentmindedly scratched at his chin.

"That would be the flag of the Chalenca Islands" he mused. "They should have no business with us or our... cargo."

At that moment, a low "pop" sounded, and a smoking missile was seen climbing through the sky. As the party looked on, it ignited blue, and slowly began falling back toward the waves.

"That is, unless, they are Navy" the Quartermaster concluded.

"Positions!" The First Mate called. "Men! To your stations!"

Catching the eye of his Surgeon, composed himself.

"And ladies."

As she gathered her pack of salves and bandages, she smiled at him.

"You'd best remember that. The way this looks, you'll be thanking me later."

The Clairvoyance, her cannons readied, her crew with bated breath, changed course to meet the new challenger.

A half written word document, some index cards, and a lot of improvisation was the first version of my naval rules. More improvisation than usual, I mean.

After a fierce couple rounds exchanging cannon fire, my party narrowly escaped their sinking ship onto the enemy captain's own. While the monk took him one on one, the barbarian, bard on her back, literally flew into the fray. The sorcerer found an advantageous position, raining fire across the deck. In that moment, I knew I wanted more.

As it turns out, transforming a ruleset made completely for land to the water requires a pretty severe overhaul. This wasn't going to be a patch for a theme, or ideas for a DM to start with - this was going to be the foundation and framework of naval campaigning in Dnd - both for myself and others.

I decided, early on, that I wanted to give a potential answer to any question that could be asked. Even if I didn't plan to use it. I would rather include too much and let users slim it down than expecting them to make rules themselves.

Extras and More

Looking for more naval content? The subreddit for Naval rules, questions, companion resources and other discussion is [r/5eNavalCampaigns](https://www.reddit.com/r/5eNavalCampaigns). Come check us out! Here you can find a collection of resources to help your game, including those specially made for this guide. While you're there, drop me some feedback! It means a lot that you might be interested in helping turn this into best guide it can be. A big thank you to all of those who have helped already!

Using This Guide

A Naval Reference

I recommend using this guide for the water as you might use the DMG for land - as a reference for when you are unsure on a ruling, and not something to be memorized. At first this may be a lot (same as when you first started!) but after a time you will develop your own rulings and rely on this guide less. While I consider every rule to have its place, you may not, and that's okay! Create the experience you want and let me help you!

Playing Surfaces

Throughout this guide, several different play surfaces (both in and out of game) are referenced.

The first of these are "Combat Hexes". Similar to the grid or hex you may use during combat, **Naval Combat takes place on 25ft hexes**. These hexes are what the "Speed" of ships refers to, as well as cannon ranges, etc.

IRL, Naval Combat does not have to take place on a hex mat- instead, it can be played on an unmarked surface. The following changes should be made:

- Replace any mention of "Hexes" with the Imperial Unit "Inches"
- When moving, ships cannot move backwards. The bow may only move in the fore direction. Each ship may move a number of inches equal to their speed. Each of the Field of Fire templates have a "1 inch" mark, measured from the edge.
- Cannon ranges are also converted to inches (1 inch for every 25 ft). It is recommended to cut a length of string with inches marked for easy measuring.

The other measurement mentioned are "Travel Hexes" and are referred to by the "Travel Speed" of ships. These are the sort of hexes are the scale seen in WotC's "Kingdom-Scale" maps. These hexes are roughly 6 miles each and are only used in relation to traveling far distances, such as across seas or island to island.

Tiers of Rules

The Naval Code is a modular ruleset. The rules are designed so that any combination of them should result in a rewarding naval experience.

Throughout the document, alternative rules are given in yellow boxes. These rules may simplify the game or add an extra level of complexity. A summary of tiers and a collection of their exact changes can be found in the reference section. The Tiers are as follows:

- **Captain Hook:** Which ignores or simplifies many rules, and is best for quickly adding ships to a game. If you think this may be the route you are interested in, I recommend checking out "The Naval Code: Abridged." It made no sense to have to hunt through rules you were unlikely to use, so I compiled the essential ones in this shorter version.
- **Pirates of the Caribbean:** The guide in its natural state
- **Documentary:** For players who wish for gritty sea life.

PART 1

The Ship



Ship Properties

Class

Ships are categorized into classes based on their size. Each class of ship has different base statistics, found below in the "Base Ship Statistics" table. There are many types of ships in each class, whose unique [stat blocks](#) are listed in the references.

1st Rate Ships

100x30 ft. (4x1 hexes)

1st Rate ships are the powerhouses of the sea. Expensive and grand, a harbor rarely has more than a handful docked at once. Navies only bring these out in dire circumstances due to the enormous costs in maintaining and manning them, but when they do, they get the job done. 1st Rate ships have 3 decks, The Main deck which houses many cannons and the masts, with the wheel atop the aft castle. The Gun deck has many of the living quarters in the forecastle, with officer quarters in the aft. The kitchen and other spaces are also on this level. The Orlop deck acts as storage as well as a brig in many ships.

2nd Rate Ships

80x25 ft. (3x1 hexes)

The most common vessel on the sea, 2nd Rate ships are as diverse in function as they are effective. From pursuit to smuggling, 2nd Rates are large enough to handle themselves without being the floating fortresses of the 1st. These will be the most common ship for campaigns; affordable enough to customize but with enough weight to throw around. Generally boasting 2 decks, some of the larger styles have 3. The Lower deck has storage in the center, with crew fore and officers aft. Space is limited, and so Officers will likely share 2-3 rooms. The Main deck is like that of 1st rate.

Unrated

40x20 ft. (2x1 hexes)

Unrated ships are simple and fast. While seaworthy, these don't hold a candle to their larger brethren. Able to be manned by a small amount of men, these may be owned by fisherman, small groups, or wealthy aristocrats who wish to spend a day sailing. Don't let their size fool you, however, as their maneuverability and high AC make them a worthy threat. Without space for a battery of cannons, unrated ships are more intent on the boarding of others, and their stats reflect that. While many unrated ships have 2 decks, some do not have a lower deck at all. Small ships all share several additional characteristics, apart from their own unique differences.

Speed

Like characters, ships may move up to their speed on each of their turns. The speed of a ship refers to the number of **25 ft. hexes** it may move on a single turn. Smaller ships are faster than large ones, which is important for maneuvering around their cannons and gaining opportunities for boarding.

For more information on how ships move in Naval Combat, see [Movement](#).

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- **Traveling Speed** While the maneuverability of smaller ships allows them to move quickly around a battlefield, they are unable to keep that speed consistently. The raw sailing power of larger ships keeps them consistent, and so are greater over long distances. Ships have a travel speed equal to the number of **6-mile hexes** they are able to travel in a day (assuming 8 hours of travel). These values are what is referenced in the Pilot travel role, and are the basis for the traveling system, where a full day of travel is the full amount.

Traveling Speed

Ship	Slow Pace	Normal Pace	Fast Pace
1st Rate	4	7	9
2nd Rate	4	6	8
Unrated	4	5	7
Smaller Craft	1	2	3

If a ship is following a current or trade wind, give a +2 to the traveling speed of the ship. If the crew plans to sail for a longer period than 8 hours (but not overnight), then add an additional hex for every 2 hours traveled past 8.

Damage Threshold

Ships are hardy structures which require a considerable attack to take damage. The damage of a single attack must be greater than the damage threshold or have no effect at all on the ship or rigging. This number is not subtracted from damage, it is all or nothing.

Siege Weapons ignore the Damage Threshold of ships.

Storage Capacity

This value does not concern cannons, crew, etc. but pertains only to items, rations, and other things being stored. Beyond this value, each ship has room for chests. All officers share access to 2 lock boxes below deck and possess a smaller locker within their living quarters.

Davit Slots

Davits are cranes to hold lifeboats. A ship can hold a number of life boats equal to its davit slots before they begin to take up storage space. By installing Davits (up to the number of slots the ship has), the lifeboat it holds can be lowered as an object interaction instead of an action. (See Davit section in Ship Enhancements.)

Base Ship Statistics

Class	Base Price	Size	Speed	Number of Masts	Davit Slots	Damage AC	Threshold	HP	Hp	Effective Cannons (Min/Max)	Skeleton Crew	Max Crew	St
1st Rate	35k	125 x 30ft	2	3	10	8	25	700	50	10/26	40	70	6,0 lbs
2nd Rate	20k	80 x 25ft	3	2	6	10	20	500	25	4/8	15	40	4,0 lbs
Unrated	10k	40 x 20ft	3	1	2	13	15	400	25	3/4	5	15	3,2 lbs

HP

- **HP:** The HP of a ship. Ships become crippled under a certain value (Effective HP) and begin sinking at 0.
- **Rigging HP:** The HP of the Rigging. This is determined by the number of masts on the ship. Each Mast a ship has adds 40 rigging HP. Taking damage to the rigging affects the movement of the ship (Rigging HP section).
- **Effective HP:** Below this threshold, the ship is nearly wrecked and several restrictions are placed on actions and movement. This is where most ship battles end.

More information regarding the HP of ships can be found in the [Hit point](#) section.

Siege Weapons

Most ships have some form of siege weapons, with cannons being the most sophisticated choice. There many choices of siege weapons that can be invested in with a number of upgrades.

Max: How many cannons a ship can hold **per side** (Port and Starboard)

Minimum: An estimate of how few siege weapons any given ship will carry per side - they could of course have fewer.

Crew

Crew are the sailors who work, live, and die on the ship. While this conversationally includes "Officers", the influential positions PC's are able take, "crew" refers to the unskilled laborers that are hired to work the lines and cannons. Skilled crew are also a potential option, persons with proficiencies who are qualified to act as officers.

Skeleton Crew

The minimum number of workers on a ship needed to make journeys on it without risking exhaustion. This number takes into account the total number of officers, combat units, and the skilled and unskilled crew. More workers are needed to travel around the clock.

(See [Night Shift](#))

Documentary Mode: Skeleton crew does not include manning cannons. During combat, ¼ of Skeleton may not be used for any other purposes and must be working sailing, or else pilot checks are made at disadvantage.

Max Crew: Total number of persons a ship can house. This includes all crew, officers, and passengers. Can be filled over this with consequences: For every day traveled over capacity, an officer must make a persuasion or intimidation check, DC = 12 + the number of people over capacity. On a failure, morale lowers, and long rests act as short rests for the next day.

Each consecutive check using the same skill raises the DC by 2. On a success, the crew and passengers are placated for 24 hours, wherein another check is required. Even on a success, there may be ramifications based on the tactics that are used. You don't want to lie to a bunch of pirates.

Ship Upkeep

Ships can be repaired and improved at most harbors. Repairs will take 1 day for every 50 hp missing and cost 2 gp per hp repaired (3 gp for a 2nd rate craft, 5 gp for a 1st rate) + 100g for every 40hp of rigging. (Base Prices, some areas could be more or less expensive). Other specifics will need be negotiated as needed.

Enhancements and Upgrades may be ordered and installed during this same time period.

"Alright, then." the Quartermaster said.

"We seem to be ready to make sail. 3 light cannons and a Medium to a side should be more than enough"

The First mate, standing nearby, looked quizzically at him. "The Clairvoyance" is small by Navy Standards. Shouldn't we focus more on our maneuvers than our guns?

The Quartermaster regarded the youth with a practiced eye.

"And, what do you suppose we would do with all that maneuvering? I don't pretend these cannons put us at the top of the food chain - but without them we are sitting ducks."

"You're not all wrong though. Without our speed, these cannons would be worthless. That's what gives us the edge, what gives us a chance. So, good mind of you."

The Captain and Master Gunner were poring over some document near the helm, and the Surgeon, a new member, had found herself a seat by the railing. The Boatswain came above deck, signaling that his repairs were done. Everything was in place, then. It was time to set off.

Officers

Every ship has several Officers who share the responsibility of leadership. Player characters or other skilled characters may take up to **2** Officer Positions each, benefiting from the features and actions of both simultaneously. Many positions are unique and may be taken by only one person at a time. Some have restrictions, requiring the ability to cast spells or certain proficiencies. Printable reference cards for officer positions are available at [r/5eNavalCampaigns](https://www.reddit.com/r/5eNavalCampaigns)

The positions and their focus are:

-
- **Captain, First Mate, and Quartermaster:** Leadership and Support
 - **Helmsman:** Piloting the Ship
 - **Cannoneer:** Making Attacks with Siege Weapons
 - **Master Gunner:** The Head Cannonneer
 - **Surgeon:** Recovering Casualties
 - **Boatswain:** Repairing the Ship and Weapons
 - **Arcanist / Militant:** Spell Casters or Martial Fighters

All Officers share a position of authority, and as such may give orders to crew (Charisma checks if applicable).

Officer Positions are not restrictions, although some may require constant attention.

During Naval Combat, ships take initiative, and every member of ship acts as one cohesive unit. Rather than taking full individual turns, Officers may only take a single action each on their ship's turn. For information on how this works, see ["Officer Locations"](#). Each Officer Position offers additional actions on top of any other actions you can normally take. These actions are Naval-Combat specific, such as firing cannons or piloting the ship.

Features and Actions granted by officer positions are only available during Naval Combat.

Each Position also comes linked a Travel Role; a responsibility you are trusted with while making journeys on the sea, such as navigating or keeping a lookout. The implementation of these roles are further discussed in "Making A Journey". A quick guide to these roles is available in the "Printable" section.

Officer Positions can be taken or swapped as an action but carry over across non-combat scenarios. There is no need to re-take officer positions.

If initiative is called and you do not have an officer position, or wish for a different one, an action will need to be taken to have it swapped / assigned to you.

Captain

Honorary: *Captain*

Maximum: 1

The Captain, First Mate, and Quartermaster are generally charismatic officers. While the names may imply authority, remember that all Officers share the top of the hierarchy of a ship. Still, a ship would be amiss without someone calling themselves “Captain” and wearing a funny shaped hat.

Without a specific responsibility during combat, these positions focus on supporting others and have the unique ability to take the Boarding Action, in which the entire ship participates. While their Available Actions are the same, differences lie in the Travel Role of each.

Available Actions:

- **Rally:** Give a d6 Inspiration Die to an ally. A Charisma Check, DC dependent on the situation, is required. You may use this action only once per battle.
- **Assess:** An Investigation check to locate any weakness of an opponent's ship. If successful, you have advantage on your next attack or contest against them for the next minute.
- **Assign Position:** As an action, you may immediately replace one officer's position, promote someone to an officer position, etc. The target must accept this change.
 - You may also use this action to relocate a number of gunners up to double your proficiency bonus to new cannons.
- **Board:** Free Action. Give the order to Board. See [Boarding](#) for more information

Travel Role

- **Navigator** The Navigator helps plan the route for the ship and assists the Helmsman on their journey. Make a Nature / Survival check at each part of the day (5 total), against the same DC as the Helmsman's survival checks. You gain a +1 to Navigation checks if you have access to a map (you must recognize both where you and your destination are on it)
- Each success by the Navigator awards the Helmsman +1 bonus to their survival check.
- Once the Navigator fails 2 checks, they are unable to give bonuses for the rest of the day.





First Mate

Honorary: *Mr.*
Maximum: 1

The Captain, First Mate, and Quartermaster are generally charismatic officers. While the names may imply authority, remember that all Officers share the top of the hierarchy of a ship. Still, a ship would be amiss without a jack - of - all - trades to act as the right hand to the other officers.

Without a specific responsibility during combat, these positions focus on supporting others and have the unique ability to take the Boarding Action, in which the entire ship participates. While their Available Actions are the same, differences lie in the Travel Role of each.

- **Rally:** Give a d6 Inspiration Die to an ally. A Charisma Check, DC dependent on the situation, is required. You may use this action only once per battle.
- **Assess:** An Investigation check to locate any weakness of an opponent's ship. If successful, you have advantage on your next attack or contest against them for the next minute.
- **Assign Position:** As an action, you may immediately replace one officer's position with another, promote someone to an officer position, etc. The target must accept this change.
 - You may also use this action to relocate a number of gunners up to double your proficiency bonus to new cannons
- **Board:** Free Action. Give the order to Board. See [Boarding](#) for more information

Travel Feature

- **Shipman.** The first mate is known to be a jack of all trades. As such, you are able to help more than normal.
- When you choose to assist another role in their responsibilities, you grant a +2 to their rolls, instead of the usual +1.

Quartermaster

Honorary: Master

Maximum: 1

The Captain, First Mate, and Quartermaster are generally charismatic officers. While the names may imply authority, remember that all Officers share the top of the hierarchy of a ship. Still, a ship would be amiss without someone to help take care of the crew and their quarters.

Without a specific responsibility during combat, these positions focus on supporting others and have the unique ability to take the Boarding Action, in which the entire ship participates. While their Available Actions are the same, differences lie in the Travel Role of each.

Available Actions:

- **Rally:** Give a d6 Inspiration Die to an ally. A Charisma Check, DC dependent on the situation, is required. You may use this action only once per battle.
 - **Assess:** An Investigation check to locate any weakness of an opponent's ship. If successful, you have advantage on your next attack or contest against them for the next minute.
-
- **Assign Position:** As an action, you may immediately replace one officer's position with another, promote someone to an officer position, etc. The target must accept this change.
 - You may also use this action to relocate a number of gunners up to double your proficiency bonus to new cannons.
 - **Board:** Free Action. Give the order to Board. See [Boarding](#) for more information

Travel Role

- **Cook.** A ship's cook is more concerned about preparing and keeping a balanced nutrition for crew than the actual food. Having a dedicated cook results in high quality rations:
 - Having a cook decreases the chance of disease and promotes higher morale.
 - After a full day of having a cook, anyone who ate their food may spend one free hit die on their next short rest. Benefit fades at the end of the day following.

Helmsman

Honorary: *Mr.*

Maximum: 1

Recommended: Proficiency in Water Vehicles

Restriction: Cannot also be a Cannoneer or Master Gunner

Manning the wheel, the Helmsman is responsible for safely navigating the vessel to its destination. While other Officers should weigh in on the direction of the ship, the Helmsman has the final say and makes the rolls. In combat, the Helmsman might be taking Evasive Maneuvers to avoid the enemy's cannons or ramming the prow directly into another ship. While most officers may only take a single action each turn during Naval Combat, you may also take a Bonus Action, which may only be used for your pilot checks. If you take a non-pilot action, then your pilot checks have disadvantage until the start of your next turn. Remember, don't drive distracted!

Available Actions:

- ***Evasive Maneuver:*** Dex/Str/Int Pilot Check with disadvantage: If successful, immediately add your proficiency bonus to the ship's AC and gain advantage on the next pilot check to contest a boarding check until the start of your next turn. 1/2 Speed next turn.
- ***Come About (Evasive Maneuver Variant):*** Uses full Movement, pilot check to succeed. The aft most section of ship moves to inhabit the hex forward to the one the bow was previously in, and the bow moves in a straight line over so that the ship extends perpendicular to its former orientation. 1/2 speed next turn. May cause overboard saves, and consecutive attempts are more difficult. See '[Come About](#)' in the movement section for the full mechanics.
- ***Ram:*** Ram your prow into another ship using your movement. 1d12 damage per hex traveled in straight line (that round, Max 10, Minimum 2), taking 1/2 damage back to your ship.
- ***Boarding Check:*** Roll to try and grapple a targeted ship at the end of a turn the [Boarding](#) action was taken.
- ***Pilot:*** Bonus Action. Dex/Str/Int/Wis checks to steer. Ability dependent on what needs to be done (see Pilot Check section under Movement) If this bonus action is not made, ship will continue course but list with the wind (assuming no other factors) If you take a non-pilot action, then your pilot checks have disadvantage until the start of your next turn.

Travel Role:

- **Pilot.** When making a journey, this role is responsible for making the Best of 5 Survival / Nature skill checks each day to plan and execute a course. Anything that gives bonuses to navigation checks has the same effect on these rolls.
- Best of 5 checks throughout the day.
 - If more successes than the DC (Base DC: 2), then subtract 1 day of travel from the total journey time. On a failure, subtract ½ day from the trip. See "Making a Journey" for more information.
- Checks are made with disadvantage if the pilot is not proficient in Vehicles (Water).

Master Gunner

Honorary: *Master*

Maximum: 1

Behold your artillery, Master Gunman. While you roll attacks and damage for the cannons under your control the same as any normal Cannoneer, you have the unique ability to order any side of the ship to fire all their cannons at once in a massive Broadside. This devastating attack will be sure to satiate your appetite for destruction.

Feature:

- Automatically gain the Officer Position “Cannoneer” – together, these two officer positions count as only having 1. Cannons under your control require one less gunner than normal (min. 1).

Available Actions:

- **Call Broadside:** (Recharge 5-6) See [Broadside Section](#)

Cannoneer

Honorary: *Mr.*

Maximum: 4

Cannons require men to man them, and men require other men to lead them. As a cannoneer, you oversee cannons on one side of the ship. Repairing misfires and giving extra guidance to your men, you have the final decision on which of your cannons will be fired at the enemy- and the distinct honor of making the rolls. That's a lot of dice.

Feature: Oversee Cannons

Select one side of the ship. If there are to be more than 2 cannoneers, you should instead select a single deck and side. You may not select cannons that are already under a different cannoneer's jurisdiction.

You are in control of all cannons that are assigned to that side, and count as one gunner for the sake of manning them. Firearm proficiency is not required to be a cannoneer. Effects that deal damage when you hit (Hunter's Mark, Hex) only trigger if you are personally manning a siege weapon - not to cannons you are overseeing.

Available Actions:

- ***Fire!*** Make any number of attacks with cannons under your control.
- ***Concentrate:*** Move to assist another Cannoneer. While there, you may help man a siege weapon of your choice. If you have proficiency in Firearms, you may add your proficiency bonus to hit for whichever weapon you are manning. You may return to your position as a free action.
- ***Repair:*** Using Tinker's or Smiths' tools, make a check to repair a misfired cannon (DC= 8+ Misfire Score). The cannon does not need to be one under your control. Failure results in the cannon dropping to 0 hp. Must be proficient in the tools you use.
- ***Assess:*** Investigation check to locate any weakness of an opponent's ship. If successful, you have advantage on your next attack or contest against them for the next minute.

Surgeon

Honorary: *Dr.*

Maximum: None

Requirement: Medicine Skill or other Healing Means

The Seas are a dangerous place, Doctor, and the burden of life in Naval Combat lies on your shoulders. As crew are injured, you may use your action to attempt to get them on their feet again. Be sure to check out the Casualties section to better understand what your position may require. Remember, everyone on the other side is working as hard as they can to make your life hell. Have fun!

Available Actions:

- ***Treatment*** (Medicine or appropriate tool Check): On a successful check and one use of a Healer's Kit, you may return one crew casualty back to the fight. If your current crew count is not equal to your total, add one back (up to the original total) This action cannot be taken if you already have crew equal to your total crew. Reference Casualties for more information.
- Example: During battle, 3 of your 30 crew fell (27/30 Crew). On a success, you may add 1 crew back, your new crew count being 28/30. Assuming no more casualties, you may take this action 2 more times returning the crew to 30/30, at which point this action cannot be taken.

Travel Role

- **Surgeon.** Spend your day treating the wounded or sick. Requires proficiency in Medicine or an appropriate tool.
- On a successful medicine check, 1d4 people may gain the effects of a Lessor Restoration Spell, with the added benefit of decreasing exhaustion levels by 1.



Boatswain

Honorary: *Master*

Maximum: 1

What a Doctor does for people, you do for boats. Only, your instruments aren't as dainty, and boats can't sue. Take your actions patching up holes and repairing sails- whatever you

can to keep your feet dry. If you have a spare moment, fix a cannon or two. Everyone will thank you for it.

Available Actions:

- **Order Repairs:** As an action, you supervise repairs. Choose to repair either the ship or the rigging. The ship recovers hit points equal to **1d4 + your level**, or the rigging recovers **1d4 + your proficiency bonus**. If you are proficient with carpenters' tools, you may add your proficiency bonus to the HP gained (even if you already added it once). **You may use this action 3 times per day.**
 - You may also use this action to attempt to repair a misfired cannon. Using it for this purpose does not count against the total for the day.
- **Assess:** Investigation check to locate any weakness of an opponent's ship. If successful, you have advantage on your next attack or contest against them for the next minute. You may add your proficiency modifier to this check, regardless of your proficiency in the skill.

Travel Role

-
- **Carpenter.** Spend the day repairing the ship
 - The adventuring day is made up of 5 parts. For each of those in which you did not spend time doing anything else (combat, other actions, adventure, etc.), make a Carpenter's tools check (DC: 15). On 3 passes, you may add **2d6 x your proficiency bonus** HP back to the ship. You may split this between Ship and Rigging HP as you see fit.
 - Assisting this role gives a +1 to each check that you are present for.

Arcanist

Honorary: *Magus/Arcan*

Maximum: None

Requirement: Ability to cast at least one spell

Some say cannons were invented only to let the mundane contend with the arcane. Arcanists are a central component of any successful ship- leaving port without one is considered foolhardy. While the other officers spend their time wrestling with the ship, take advantage of your own power to influence the battle. Climb to the crow's nest and rain down fire or obscure your vessel in a well of fog.

Unlike other Officers, you may take full turns on the ship- but that does come with restrictions. While others are not constrained to any physical space, you are. You can't cast a lightning bolt from the crow's nest if the turn before you were helping below deck. Your turns on the ship act exactly as they do on land. This physical location overrides the lack of location most officers have.

Feature:

-
- As an Arcanist, you may use ship turns as you own turn, taking full turns of actions, bonus actions, movement, etc. Your responsibilities to the ship include helping others with their roles, casting offensive and defensive spells, or doing whatever you deem appropriate. See the [Magic Section](#) for information on how spells interact with Naval and Ship-bound combat.
 - Unlike normal Naval Combat, your location defines what actions are available to be taken- **To take an action granted by an officer position, you must be in the Associated Location of the position that grants you that action.**
 - So, as a Pilot/Arcanist, you must move to the helm to take any actions associated with piloting. For information on how to take actions, and how to interact with other officers, see the [Associated Locations](#) Table in the Combat Section.

Available Actions:

- **Arcane Well:** As an Action, you may begin concentrating on your magic. If by your next turn you have not lost concentration, nor failed a Dexterity save due to the ship's movement, you may roll 1d4-1 (minimum result of 1), gaining a spell slot of that level to use **only that turn**. If you do not have access to the level gained, you instead gain the highest level you have access to. You may take this action a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest.
-

Note: As with all officer actions, this action may only be taken during Naval Combat.

Travel Role

-
- **Lookout** Responsible for making Perception checks to notice landmarks, obstacles, encounters, etc. If you have a lookout at the start of a Naval Encounter, you gain a +1 to the ship's initiative (even if the lookout missed the threat).

Turn - By - Turn

A turn-by-turn example of an Arcanist
(With the second officer position of First Mate)
to help illustrate the Arcanist's feature:

-
- **Turn 1:** Begins in the crow's nest- *Action:* "Firebolt". *Movement:* move down the ladder to the deck (Full movement)
 - _____
 - _____
 - _____
 - _____
 - **Turn 2:** *Movement:* Moves to the wheel. *Action:* "Guidance" on the pilot. *Movement:* Begin moving back to Mast.
 - _____
 - _____
 - _____

-
- **Turn 3:** *Action:* “Arcane Well”, *Movement:* Begin climbing ladder. Saves on Overboard Save from *About Face*.

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

-
- **Turn 4:** Arcane Well grants a 3rd level spell slot. *Movement:* Reaches the top of the mast. *Action:* Casts “Magic Missile” at 3rd level.

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

- **Turn 5:** *Movement:* Climbs back down Mast- *Action:* Dash, making it halfway to the lower deck.

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

- **Turn 6:** *Movement:* Finishes climbing down the deck, *Action:* “Rallies” (First Mate) the Master Gunner.

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

- **Turn 7:** *Action:* Medicine check to assist Surgeon (Success). *Movement:* Back up to the main deck.

Variant Arcanist: *Militant*

Militants are Martial Combat Officers who share all the same features and rules as Arcanists, but do not require the ability to cast spells. *Arcane Well* is replaced with *Warrior's Focus*.

Variant Action: *Warrior's Focus*: As an action, begin concentrating on an attack, with the same concentration rules as *Arcane Well*. If, by the start of your next turn, your Concentration has not been broken, your next weapon attack has Advantage on both the Attack and Damage rolls. This bonus does not apply to Siege Weapons. You may use this action a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest.

General Actions

These actions are available to any Officer during Naval Combat. This list is not exhaustive.

- **Any actions or bonus actions a character may normally take** (Bonus Actions may be taken using the officer's action)
- Give orders to Crew
- Participate in Boarding
- **Ready for Combat:** As an action, gain advantage on individual initiative if standard combat begins before the start of your ship's next turn.
- Interact with anything on the boat
- **Brace Yourself:** Gain Advantage on Overboard or Displacement Effect Saves until start of next turn
- Man Cannons: Count as a person, may use specialized shots, etc.
- Assist another Officer's Action:
 - Help pull lines, handle ropes, etc. (+1 Pilot Check)
 - Assist Surgeon: Surgeon can make an additional medicine check for +1 crew. This check is made at disadvantage unless you have medicine proficiency, or another means of healing available.
 - Assist Boatswain: +1 to Check, add your Intelligence Score to the HP gained

- Leave the Ship: Whether by Small Craft, Rope Swings, Jumping Overboard, Etc.
See [Leaving the Ship](#) for more information.

Making a Journey

In a setting which revolves vehicles, traveling from place to place is a key part of the game. No one buys a ship to let it sit in the harbor! These journeys are exciting and often as fruitful as the goal itself. It is between locations that the joys and discoveries of a naval campaign come to life.

Starting

At the onset of a journey, a destination, however tentative, must be decided. A location on a map, following a series of directions, a known location, or a basic direction are all acceptable.

Making Ready a ship takes 10 Minutes, decreased by 1 minute for every person proficient in water vehicles involved. Making ready involves untethering from the dock, prepping lines and sails, organizing crew, etc. Remember, a ship must have above its Skeleton Crew to make a journey without risking exhaustion.

Travel

Based off the *Darker Dungeons Homebrew*, traveling on ships is based around Travel Roles- the responsibilities each Officer has available to take on. It is recommended to see the source for any questions regarding traveling.

At the beginning of the adventuring day, you may choose to fulfill **one** of the roles granted by your officer positions, assist another in their role (granting a +1 to their rolls), or neither. Fulfilling a role is an all day commitment.

As a group, you must also decide on the pace of travel - the speeds of each class of ship are given in the [Travel Speed](#) Section.

Your Officer Position defines what roles are available to you. You may elect to change one of your officer positions to gain a certain role. This can be done easily out of combat. Be wary though - once initiative is called, if you want to switch back, it will require an action to do so.

When fulfilling a role, consider it the equivalent of traveling over land – you can't participate in downtime activities while actively scouting for danger. Over the day, rolls are made by the DM to discover if anything happens- and what that thing may be.

You may not rest while fulfilling a traveling role. It is not required for every party member to take a role, but to make a journey at all you must have a Pilot. If you do not take a role, you may spend the day as you please- downtime activities, resting, etc.- but know that others may not look kindly at too many days off.

Many of the roles echo the originals outlined in the source material, with some additions due to the necessities of life on the high sea. For more information on how to use this traveling mechanic, please reference the Darker Dungeons PDF @ [r/darkerdungeons5e](#)

Night Shift

While ships traditionally do not travel during the night, the ship still requires at least one person to keep her steady.

For each portion of watch, a pilot check is made to keep the ship under control on top of a traditional perception check (Pilot DC: 5).

The ship makes very little progress over night, as sails are generally up. If the crew wishes to travel through the night, a number equal to skeleton crew will need to have not worked or fought over the day and will not be able to participate in anything until a potential night shift comes again. Navigation checks are made with disadvantage at night.

Arrival

Upon reaching the destination, there are several options on how to proceed. If the water is deep enough, the ship can be pulled right to land. Should there be a dock, the ship could be tied there. If the water is too shallow, or the area unsavory, boats can be taken ashore. When this second option is taken, the ship generally sits around 600 ft. from shore, and one or more capable crew are left aboard to look after it.

Captain Hook Mode: Officer Positions and their travel roles do not have to be linked. Instead, players are allowed to choose from any of the roles to fulfill throughout the day. These work exactly the same, and this style is closer to the original source.

Crew

Non-Officers; Crew are skilled and unskilled NPC's who assist on the ship. Crew are key to sailing the ship (See [Skeleton Crew](#)) and manning cannons in Naval Combat. Crew take care of menial tasks so that the officers don't have to. Larger ships require more crew in order to be functional.

Most crew are "Unskilled", in that they have a commoner's stat block and no proficiencies. These crew cannot be officers but are cheap to hire. Being unskilled does not mean that they are not competent: these men are seamen who are able to carry out the various

aspects of seafaring. They are dependable workers, not prone to poor decisions or failure at basic tasks. Being unskilled just denotes their **inability to** **take officer position**, their lack of specialization, and their inclusion in things such as [Casualty Rolls](#).

"Skilled" Crew refers to crew who are proficient in a skill (and receive a +5 to checks with it). These are professionals, and their price reflects that. While you can find unskilled crew at any harbor or tavern, Skilled crew are less common and may need to be sought out. Skilled hirelings come in a variety, so prices may vary. Someone with a single proficiency in a low-demand skill may ask 5 gp a day, while a caster who will be asked to fight will likely ask for more than 100 gp (and may haggle for a cut of the profit).

Unskilled Crew are, by default, non-combative. For this reason, **they should not be considered during Standard Combat**. Fighting a large ship does not mean fighting against 50+ people, but only the combat units the ship keeps. It is up to the DM to respect this, or to warn their players if they plan for the crew to be involved. The crew are not on battle maps nor take up space in the environment. They are ignored until after combat is resolved.

Traits

To better characterize crew, each of them have 3 secret traits, which may be low, medium, or high. These traits don't affect any mechanics (unless you want them to), but help create meaningful characters with potential to be more:

Naval Ability:

Their skill at doing their job, knowledge of seafaring, etc.

Crew High in Naval Ability will be respected for their work, and often complete their job to excess. With training, they may be able to become a Skilled Hireling and be able to assist the pilot or navigator, and eventually take on those responsibilities themselves.

Being low in Naval Ability makes a crew member a ready target by the other crew. They may be used as a scapegoat or given extra duties. They don't have a lot of potential on the sea.

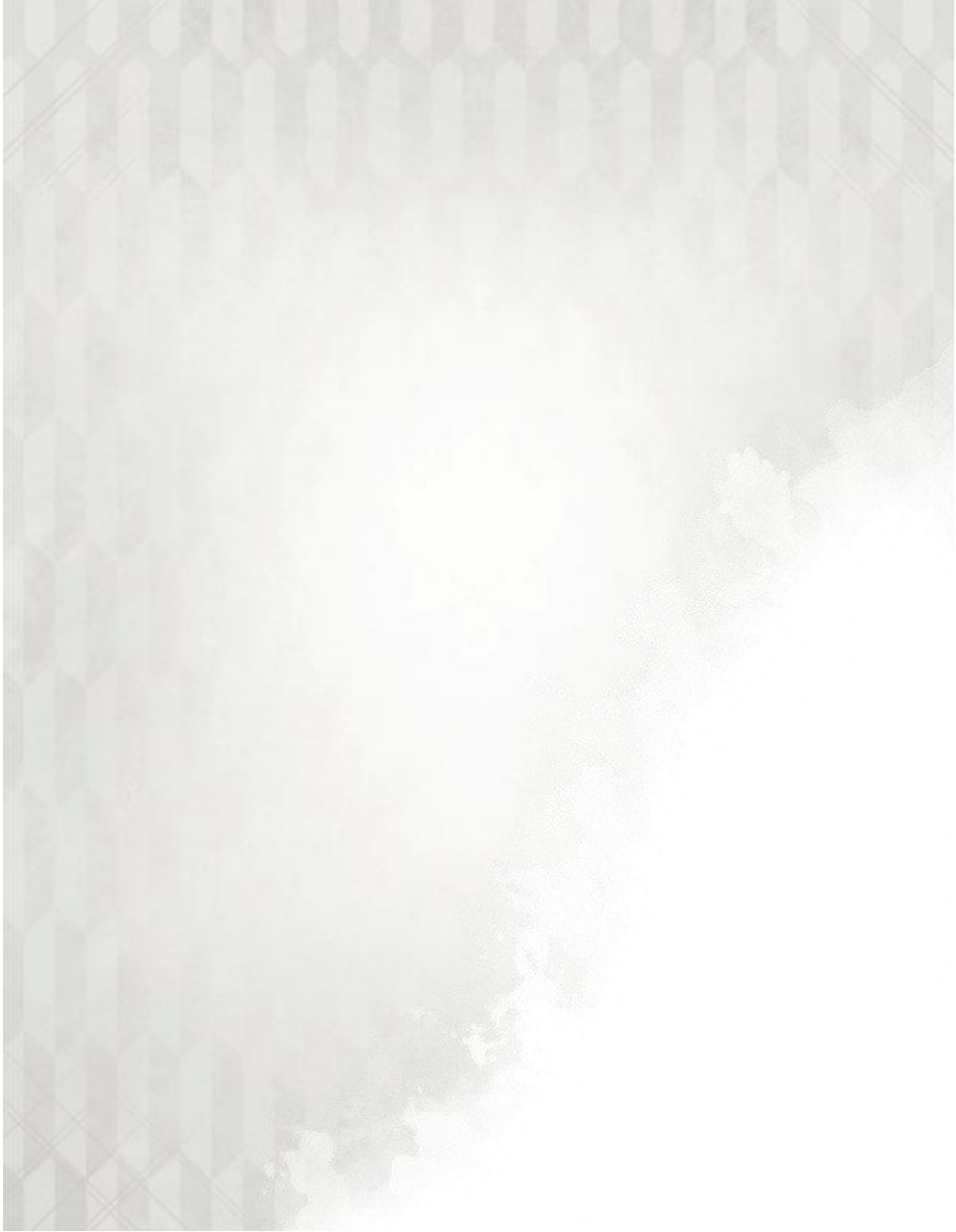
Demeanor:

A basic idea of the agreeableness of a crew member. A summary of their social skills, this has a large impact in their role on the ship, and how they respond to orders or conditions on the ship.

Crew High in demeanor are well liked among the crew, and likely the officers as well. They may be chosen as a sort of mouthpiece for the crew, communicating to the officers the state of things. They will likely seek out and quell trouble on the ship. They raise general

moral and take problems and issues in positive ways. If anything happens to them, morale could take quite a toll.

Low Demeanor crew are disliked and unwelcome by many- but not all. They may be sneaky or rude, or simply untrusted. Low demeanor crew may interpret things in the worst way, loath orders, and are quick to resort to extreme measure. Have you ever heard of a mutiny?



Martial Ability

While most crew don't take part in standard combat, you may consider using crew high in Martial Ability in the flavor of things: While they don't enter the battle as a combatant, they may help influence things in other ways. Crew high in martial Ability may eventually develop into combat units.

Crew who are low in Martial Ability are unable or unwilling to fight- this may be respected, or it may be seen as a sign of weakness by the crew.

Prices

Crew	Price (Per Day)
------	-----------------

Unskilled Crew	1 gp
----------------	------

Skilled Crew	5 - 200 gp
--------------	------------

Whenever you make landfall, it's time to even up. Add up the total salaries of your crew and pay them for each day they were with you since last you landed.

Documentary: Since crew are on call even while ashore, you must pay them half their price on the outset of your next journey for the days spent on land.

Weapons

Siege Weapon Properties

The following rules replace the ones given for siege weapons in the DMG. They introduce slightly modified mechanics to range and damage.

Gunners

Each cannon requires a certain number of gunners in order to load, aim, and fire them. There are no proficiencies required to act as a gunner, but acting as one renders you unable to take other actions. The "Required Gunners" is the minimum number that must be assigned for that cannon to be operable. Remember that this number is not compared to the total number of crew, but that crew is a finite resource assigned to cannons. Cannoneers and the Master Gunner (who doubles as a cannoneer) each count as 1 Gunner.

- So, if you have 4 gunners (including your canoneers), and 3 Light Cannons (Required Gunners: 2), only 2 of the cannons may be active at the same time.

Out of combat, you may assign people however you like to siege weapons- when initiative is rolled, it is assumed that they take their positions. Once in combat, an "Assign Position"

Action is required to change their locations. Be sure to note if you have enough crew assigned to man a cannon “**Efficiently**”.

Attacks and Damage

Siege Weapons do not add any modifiers to their attacks or damage with the exception of Carronades, which add the highest dexterity modifier of those manning it to its damage.

Physical Locations

In Naval Combat, the location of siege weapons are not tracked except their side of the ship, port or starboard. If you have more than 2 Cannoneers, you may wish to further track which deck ships are on for the sake of control.

It takes 5 minutes to change the side a weapon is positioned on.

Ammunition

The Ammunition property is the same as in 5e.

Documentary Mode: Each cannon requires a different ammunition stock, and each shot utilizes black powder (BP).

- **Carronade:** 1 lb. Cannonball, 1 unit BP
- **Light Cannon:** 4 lb. Cannonball, 1 unit BP
- **Medium Cannon:** 15 lb. cannonball, 2 units BP
- **Heavy Cannon:** 32 lb. cannonball, 3 units BP
- **Culverin:** 15 lb. cannonball, 2 units BP

HP

At 0hp, a siege weapon becomes broken. A broken weapon cannot be fixed using tinker's tools. Smith's tools, and a furnace are required to repair it at 1/4 the cost of the weapon (for materials). These repairs take one hour. Weapons are immune to Psychic and Poison damage.

Range

While similar to normal ranged attacks, siege weapons gain a bonus to hit huge or larger targets (such as all ship) that are within first range listed. The second and third numbers are the same as those for any other ranged weapon (normal and maximum range, respectively). Due to the length of their barrels or size of the machine, no siege weapon can attack targets within 5 ft of them.





Siege Weapons

Type	Cost	Required Gunners	HP	Damage	Properties
Ballista (Ba)	500 gp	2	50	2d10	Ammunition (range: 50/225/500), Loading (2), Misfire 1, Efficient, Siege
Catapult (Cat)	550 gp	3	80	2d10	Ammunition (range: 50/325/600) , Loading (2), Misfire 1, Efficient, Siege
Carronade (Car)	500 gp	1	60	2d6+Dex	Ammunition (range: 25/125/275), Loading (1), Misfire 2, Efficient, Crew Targeting, Siege, Loud, Mobile
Light Cannon (L)	1,500 gp	2	120	2d10	Ammunition (range: 100/400/725), Loading (1), Misfire 1, Efficient, Siege, Loud
Medium Cannon (M)	2,500 gp	2	120	4d10	Ammunition (range: 100/275/550), Loading (2), Misfire 1, Siege, Loud
Heavy Cannon (H)	3,500 gp	3	150	7d10	Ammunition (range: 50/125/225), Loading (2), Misfire 1, Siege, Loud
Culverin (Cu)	4,000 gp	2	120	5d10	Ammunition (range: 0/700), Loading (3), Misfire 1, Siege, Loud, Artillery
Flamethrower	Legendary	4	120	3d8	Ammunition (25 ft Cone), Loading (4), Misfire 1, Fire, Siege, Loud

New Properties:

Artillery. For every round spent aiming the shot, you may add 25ft to its furthest range
Maximum: +125 ft (5 rounds). If the full 5 rounds are spent aiming, gain advantage on the shot.

Loading (x). Weapons with this property act as if they have the loading property with an additional rule. The number in the parentheses is the load time, number of turns a weapon must take after firing before it is able to be fired again. The weapon must be manned by its minimum number of gunners throughout the loading, or else the process pauses until it is manned again. As long as it is properly manned, the loading process continues automatically as the gunners are assumed to be using their time working on it.

So, a Light Cannon, loading (1), is able to make one attack every other turn (1 turn between firing).

Loud. Attacks with this weapon are audible within 1000 ft.

Mobile. Siege Weapons with this property can be moved side-to-side as an action.

Misfire. When an attack roll is made for this weapon, and the die roll is equal to or below the misfire score for the weapon, the weapon becomes "Misfired". While Misfired, it is unusable until an action is taken to repair it (Tinker or Smith's Tools check. **DC = 8 + misfire score**). On a success, the weapon is back in working order. On a failure, the weapon is broken (See "HP" section).

Efficient. If a weapon with this property is manned by twice the minimum number, the Load Time decreases by 1 (minimum of 0).

Siege Weapon. All weapons discussed in this section count as siege weapons for the sake of double damage to structures and circumventing the damage thresholds of ships.

Crew Targeting. This weapon does not gain Disadvantage when targeting "Crew" (Disadvantage for specific targets still applies. See [Targets](#) for more details).

Siege Ammunition

The following ammunitions may be purchased and used for siege weapons. Many have restrictions as to what weapons may fire them, and many have additive effects beyond the weapons normal damage.

Boring Shot

-
- *Medium and Heavy Cannon Ammunition*

- **Specialized:** May only target the Ship. Deals an additional 1d10 Bldg. damage on hit. No damage from an attack that uses this is considered toward casualty damage.

Chain Shot

- *Ammunition (Any)*
- **Target Rigging:** Allows the targeting of Rigging without disadvantage.

Cannister Shot

- *Light or Medium Cannon Ammunition*
- **Cannister:** Lasts 6 rounds, dispersed by moderate wind or by moving 75 ft. in one turn or 100 ft. over 2 turns. Comes in two varieties:
 - **Smoke (20 gp)**
 - **Standard Combat:** Heavily Obscured 15 ft radius
 - **Naval Combat:** May only target the deck. On hit, one attack per round for the duration is made at disadvantage. (Multiple cannisters stack up to 3 attacks at disv. per round). Attacks against specific targets on the affected ship made at disadvantage for the duration. May also affect perception checks.

Siege Ammunition

Name	Price (ea.)	Available to:	Effect
Cannon Ball	3 sp	All Cannons	Basic Ammo
Catapult Ammo	2 sp	Catapults	Basic Ammo
Boring Shot	25g	M,H Cannons	
Cannister Shot	20 gp	L, M Cannons	Special: Gas Cannister

Name	Price (ea.)	Available to:	Effect
Chain Shot	15 gp	Any	Allows the targeting of Rigging without disadvantage
Explosive Shot	35 gp	L,M Cannons	Special: Explosive Shrapnel
Flair	1 gp	Ca, L Cannons	Special: Signals
Fire-Bomb Shot	35 gp	L, M, Cu Cannons	Special: Fire - Bomb
Grapeshot	15 gp	L,M,H Cannons	
Harpoon	Ballista: 25 gp Cannon: 50g	Ballista, L, M Cannons	Special: Harpoon
Pitch - Ammo	5 gp	Catapults	Special: Ignite

- **Stinking (40 gp)**
- **Standard Combat:** Heavily obscured 10 ft square. If affected: Con Save (DC: 12) or lose your next action coughing. Creatures that don't need to breathe or are immune to the poisoned condition automatically succeed on this saving throw.
- **Naval Combat:** May only target the deck - on hit, the number of cannons the affected ship may fire next turn is decreased by 2. While the effect lasts, - 1 to all siege weapon attacks from affected ship until dispersed (Multiple cannisters stack up to 3 times). Attacks against specific targets on the affected ship made at disv. for the duration.
- **Upgrade: Heavy Fumes** (+25 gp): Dispersing requires a strong wind or moving 3 hexes in one turn (or 6 over 3).

Explosive Shot

- *Light or Medium Cannon Ammunition*
 - **Explosive Shrapnel:** Ignites ships and flammable objects in the area that aren't being worn or carried. This shot has potential to impact multiple targets. See the "Targeting" Section for more details.
-

- **In Naval Combat:**
 - **Targeting Ship:** Deal an extra 1d10 piercing damage to the ship. Contributes its damage to casualties as normal +1 automatic casualty.
-

- **Targeting Crew:** No damage, automatic 1d4-1 Casualties (Minimum: 0 casualties).
- **In Standard Combat:** Targets in a 5ft radius around the impact must make a Dex save (DC: 12) or take 1d8 fire plus 1d8 piercing damage, both halved on a successful save.

Flairs

- *Carronade and Light Cannon Ammunition*
- **Signals:**
- **Red:** Danger
- **Blue:** Navy
- **Yellow-Green:** Distress

Fire-Bomb Shot

- *Light, Medium and Culverin Ammunition*
- **Fire - Bomb** 1d8 Additional Fire damage on hit. Ignites ships and flammable objects that are not being worn or carried.

Grapeshot

- *Light, Medium, or Heavy Cannon Ammunition*
- **In Naval Combat:** Cannot damage ship: when used, there is no disadvantage to target the crew. On hit, automatically causes 1d4-1 casualties.
- **In Standard Combat:** 15ft cone from the side of the target ship - dexterity save (DC: 12) or 2d8 bludgeoning damage, halved on a save.

Harpoon

- *Ballista, Light and Medium Cannon Ammunition*
- **Piercing hook:** A large, barbed hook on a length of rope. Range: 25 ft. Does not deal normal damage from cannon. Instead, deals 1d10 piercing. On hit, adds +3 to Boarding Bonus while attached. Requires a DC: 16 Athletics check to remove.
- **Upgrade: Chain** (+25g): Uses chain in place of rope.

Pitch - Ammo

- *Catapult Ammunition*
- **Ignite:** Ignites Ships and flammable objects that aren't being worn or carried.





Weapons

Weapons

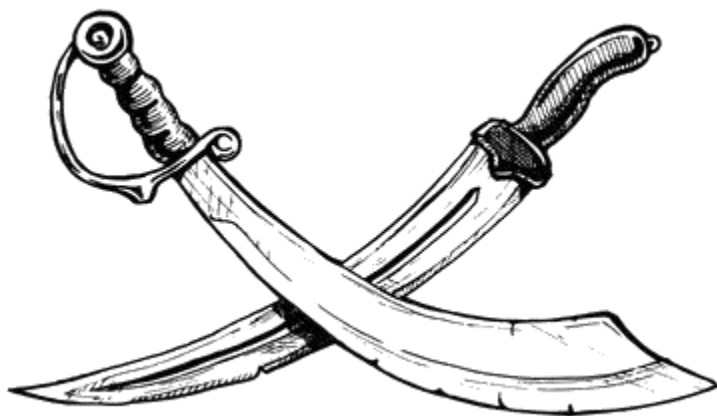
Name	Cost	Damage	Weight	Properties
<i>Simple Melee Weapons</i>				
Bayonet	5 gp	1d4 piercing	1 lb.	Finesse, light, special
Pin	1 gp	1d4 bludgeoning	2 lb.	Light
Boarding Axe	2 gp	1d6 slashing	2 lb.	Light, thrown (range 20/60), special
Hand- Hook	5 gp	1d4 piercing	1 lb.	Finesse, light, special
<i>Martial Melee Weapons</i>				
Cutlass	20 gp	1d8 slashing	2 lb.	Finesse
Dirk	10 gp	1d6 piercing	2 lb.	Finesse, light

Name	Cost	Damage	Weight	Properties
Basket-Hilt Broadsword	15 gp	1d10 slashing	3 lb.	Two Handed, Heavy
<i>Ranged Firearms</i>				
Flintlock Pistol	200 gp	1d8 piercing	5lb.	Firearm, ammunition (range: 40/160), loading, misfire 2, loud
Flintlock Musket	400 gp	1d12 piercing	10 lb.	Firearm, ammunition (range: 120/350), Reload 1, misfire 2, Heavy, two-handed, loud
Hand Mortar	150 gp	1d8 fire	3 lb.	Thrown, simple, single use (30/60), misfire 3, explosive, loud

New Properties

Firearm. The stats and properties of weapons which have this property replace the optional rules listed in the DMG. Firearms do not count as simple or martial ranged weapons; Only those with proficiency in firearms may add their proficiency bonus to attacks made with weapons which have the firearm property. Further, making attacks with a firearm without proficiency raises the misfire score by 1.

Should the "Weapon Specialist" Feature be taken to gain access to a weapon with the firearm property, you also gain proficiency with all firearms of the same nature - Pistols (one handed), Rifles (two-handed), or Cannons.



Variant Rule: Common Firearms

To increase the potential number of firearms for settings in which firearms are common, remove the "Firearm" property. Instead, all weapons with that property are considered Martial Ranged Weapons. This will increase the number of firearms in a game and allow more experimentation.

- **Explosive.** On hit, everything within 5 ft of the target must make a Dexterity saving throw (DC= 8 + your attack bonus) or take the damage. Saving results in no damage being taken. If the attack misses, the explosive fails to detonate or falls in a location where it does no damage. Access to weapons with this property should be limited.
- **Reload.** This weapon may fire a number of times equal to its reload score before 1 action or 1 attack must be used to reload it. One free hand is required to reload.

Special Weapons

- **Bayonet.** A small blade, able to be affixed to a weapon that has the ammunition property. While attached, you can choose for the weapon to change between two forms as a bonus action: Its normal form, or a martial melee weapon which deals 1d4 piercing damage.
- **Boarding Axe.** While wielding a Boarding Axe in each hand, you have advantage on athletic checks to climb wood.
- **Hand-Hook.** On a hit, instead of damage, you may attempt grapple the target with advantage as a bonus action. No advantage is gained to maintain the grapple. At your DM's discretion, you may instead try to force the target to drop an item it is holding.

Items

Item	Price	Weight	Description
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Ship Items

Rope Swings	20 gp	1 lb.	
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Rope Ladder	25 gp	4 lbs.	
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Item	Price	Weight	Description
Grappling Hooks	25 gp	1 lb.	Finesse, Thrown(range 20)

Fire Barrels	200 gp / Batch	20 lbs.	
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Gangplank	100 gp	20 lbs.	
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Anchor	20 gp	40 lbs.	
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Adventuring Gear

Astrolabe	100 gp	3 lbs	No penalty for navigating at night- Requires prof. in navigators' tools
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Bandana	1 sp	-	
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Eye Patch	1 sp	-	
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Fishing Net	2 gp	10 lbs	
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Maps	~25 gp	-	Value dependent on accuracy and content
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Reed Breathing Tube	1s	-	Hollowed out tube, 1 meter long
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Item	Price	Weight	Description
------	-------	--------	-------------

Sextant	500 gp	-	If Sun or Stars visible, +1 Navigation
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Spyglass	200 gp	-	2 handed- Advantage on perception checks
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Life Preserver	2 gp	-	
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Small Craft

Rowboat	50 gp	300 lbs.	Stat block
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Longboat	200 gp	2,000 lbs.	Stat block
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Anchor

Keeps a ship from moving- ship must already be stopped and cannot be in deep water. An action is needed to raise any anchor.

Instant Anchor: Stops a ship immediately but deals damage to the ship according to it's class: Unrated=50, 2nd rate=75, 1st rate = 100.

Grappling Hooks

Iron hooks on a length of rope. To attach, make a thrown weapon attack against the AC of the ship. For each attached hook, your ship gains a +1 to its Boarding Bonus. Successful grappling hooks break if their target moves out of their range. A grappling hook can be removed with a DC 12 Athletic check.

Fire Barrel

1 batch = 12 barrels. When exposed to fire, each creature and object within 5 feet of the barrel must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or take 4d6 Fire Damage (1/2 on success).

The barrel will stay lit for up to 1 min, emitting light and causing 1d6 fire damage to anything it comes into contact with.

When released into the sea, each batch fills a 25ft. space. A ship can make a pilot check (Dex, DC:15) to avoid hitting any. If the barrels are already on fire, on a failure, a ship take 6d10 fire damage as it hits the flaming barrels. If the barrels are not yet lit, no damage is dealt.

Barrels can be fit with a fuse. Fuse lengths can vary from 1 to 10 rounds. After being lit, roll initiative for the barrel. On that initiative, a number of rounds equal to the fuse length later, the barrel explodes.

Gangplank

A 5x15 ft long plank with weak hooks to keep hold. Gives Advantage on the acrobatic / athletics checks to cross between ships at a DC:12. As an action, a gangplank can be affixed between a ship and another ship or dock. Max 3 deployed at once. If the structures it bridges move apart further than its length, it snaps. Gangplanks have several potential upgrades:

-
- **Corvus (300 gp):** An advanced Boarding device- uses a Davit Slot. Corvus have the properties of a "Hooked" Gangplank, but do not require a person's actions to be deployed. The Corvus can be lowered as an Object Interaction instead.
 - **Extra Long (20 gp):** 20ft long
 - **Extra Wide (20 gp):** 10ft wide
 - **Hooked (20 gp):** Adds +1 to the Boarding Bonus while in place
 - **Safety Net (100 gp):** Adds a net that spans the gangplank, held out by small poles. Has the capability to hold 1 medium or smaller sized creature before bursting.

Life Preserver

Gain advantage on athletic checks related to swimming - If you are using a life preserver in water and it is affixed to a ship, you are pulled along with the ship. This does not use your movement.

Rope Swings

A length of rope suspended from the boom of a mast. Can be used as an action to swing, moving 20ft. across or off the ship in the direction of choice with acrobatic check (DC=12)
Max 5 per 50 ft. of ship

Small Craft

Small Craft are boats not fit for naval travel or combat. See the "Leaving the Ship" section in "Overboard" for information regarding taking a small craft during Naval Combat. Their size varies from 10 to 15 ft. but are represented as taking 1 hex. Full Stats are found in the Ship Stat Block section in the references.

Siege Weapons mounted in Small Craft maintain their qualities. Rather than a cannoneer to oversee it, one of the people manning it selects its targets. Small Craft cannot grapple ships but may attach themselves to be pulled along by larger ships by achieving a boarding bonus of +2 . At 0 HP they are simply destroyed.

Customization

Ship Enhancements

The following section offers customizable options for ships and cannons. Both can have as many upgrades / enhancements as can be afforded, but some upgrades cannot be added to the same unit. Build Time is 1 day for every 2,000-gold value.

Arcanist's Shield

Price: 500 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** *Defense:* A large wooden shield with an open window. Offers 3 / 4 cover. Disadvantage on assess and perception checks when in use. Can be built on deck or crow's nest. If installed on a crows nest, pick a side of the ship. It is always in effect toward that side.
 - **Further Upgrades** *Iron: +100 gp, Fire Resistant: +100 gp, Full Hut: +1000 gp, Hinged: +40 gp*

Bow / Stern Cannon Ports

Price: 2,500 gp ea., plus price of cannons

- **Characteristics:** Adds port holes for 2 siege weapons facing fore or aft. Can only fit Light Cannons, Carronades or Ballista. Acts as an additional "side" of the ship. See "Cannon Aim" for more detailed information.
- **Further Upgrades:** *Davey Jones's Triplets:* Replaces Light cannons with 3-barral cannons. *Triplets only available in Bow. Use Light cannon stats, but 1d10 damage and Loading (0)*

Crow's Nest

Price: 500g

Restriction: Only up to # of masts

-
- **Characteristics:** *High Ground:* Ranged spell and weapon attacks from the crow's nest have increased range equal to 1 / 2 their original range (100 ft → 150 ft). While in the Crows nest, when you succeed on an "Assess" action, you may grant the benefit to another person.
 - **Further Upgrades:** *Fireproof (250 gp): Nonflammable, Metal (500 gp), Feather Fall (1000 gp):* Once per day, a person in the crow's nest may use a reaction to receive the benefits of *Feather Fall* until they stop falling.

Davit

Price: 500 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** Cranes by which to suspend Lifeboats on a ship- each Davit can hold 1 boat which can be quickly deployed as an object interaction. Davits/Boats do not provide cover or take space on a battle map.
 - **Further Upgrades:** *Longboat Ready (+200g):* The Davit is extended, long enough to house a longboat.
Stacked (+350g): Davits are double tall, so that each may hold 2 boats.

Figurehead

Price: 500-2000 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** Aesthetics

- **Further Upgrades:** Can be enchanted, combined with spotlights, or combined with a ram.

Fireproofing

Prices:

Deck: 2,000 gp

Hull: 2,000 gp

Masts: 1,500 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** A fireproofed surface is considered “Nonflammable” for the sake of catching on fire. Fireproofing does not make the surface resistant to fire damage.
 - **Further Upgrades:** May add fire resistance

Glass Floor

Price: 1000 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** *Aesthetic/Exploration:* You may see into the ocean below. Damage threshold = 10, the AC is equal to the ships minus 4.
 - **Further Upgrades:** Add a Hatch.

Ironsides

Price: 100,000 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** +2 AC, Resist B/P/S from Nonmagical Weapons, Fire resistance and Inflammable. -1 speed, +1 round at 1/2 speed to stop. +6 Damage Threshold, and denies other ships the bonus of "Raking Fire". Not compatible with Live Oak or Reinforced Walls. It takes much longer to complete the upgrade than average, and is likely unavailable from most docks. It may require additional research and resources to be gathered.

Live Oak Hull

Prices:

Bow: 2,000 gp x Ship Size (Unranked=1, 2nd = 2, 1st = 3)

Stern: 2,000 gp x Ship Size

Port Side: 2,500 gp x Ship Size

Starboard Side: 2,500 gp x Ship Size.

-
- **Characteristics:** Making the hull out of solid pieces of trees as opposed to cut pieces. +1 AC and +4 damage threshold from attacks to that location. Enhancing the Bow or Stern denies other ships the "Raking Fire" damage bonus from the respective direction. It takes longer to complete this upgrade than average.
 - **Further Upgrades:** May be purchased an additional time in each location for the original price x 2, adding an additional +1 AC and +2 to damage threshold.

Oars

Price: 200 gp for a full set

-
- **Characteristics:** While used by a number of people equal to the skeleton crew of the ship, add 1 speed while in use or 2 to the travel speed if used all day. Each person may work an oar for 6 hours before requiring a Long Rest (or Short Rest but gain a level of exhaustion) before the same individual works again. No cannons are available while in use.
 - **Further Upgrades:** *Oar-Ports (1,000 gp):* Cannons may be fired while oars are in use

Ram

Price: 2,000 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** *Improved Ram:* Increase the damage from the Ramming Action to 2d12 per hex traveled, and the ramming ship takes only 1/4 damage back.
 - **Further Upgrades:** *Reinforced Hull (+2,000 gp):* Take no damage back when you use the ram action.
Hooked Ram (+1,500 gp): When the boarding action is taken, the conditions of moving the same direction and being side by side can be ignored if the pilot uses their action that turn to ram the target ship (The mechanics of ramming, including the movement needed and damage dealt by the action, are unchanged). Upon ramming, the hooks engage, giving a +5 boarding bonus. This upgrade may be combined with a gangplank, to allow passage over the hull.

Rear-Loading Cannons

Price: 2,000 gp (Whole ship)

- **Characteristics:** Increases Broadside recharge range by 1 (to recharge 4-6)

Reinforced Walls

Price: 3,000 gp X Ship Size (Unranked=1, 2nd=2, 1st=3)

- **Characteristics:** +50 Ship HP. This can be taken multiple times, up to 3.

Rotating Turret

Price: 1,000 gp ea.

- **Characteristics:** *Swivel:* A siege weapon mounted on a rotating turret can fire at targets on either side, as well as ahead of the ship. Uses a Davit Slot.

Sail-Drop

Price: 2,000 gp

- **Characteristics:** Adds the capability to drop all the sails as an action (Pilot or Captain/First mate/Quartermaster) - Gain double speed for one round but take 50% of your total rigging HP as damage afterwards.

Ship Haul

Price: 100 gp each

- **Characteristics:** Attach hooks to either the bow or stern of the ship in order to haul / be hauled. Each hook can hold / pull up to a Large sized creature or object. For each size larger, an addition hook is needed.

Ship in a Bottle

Price: Varying. 700 gp for a lifeboat

-
- **Characteristics:** *Free:* Upon breaking or unstopping the bottle, the ship rapidly grows to fill its normal space, following rules the same as an Instant Fortress. One Use.

Spikes

Price: 3,000 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** *Defensive:* Doubles damage to ships which ram it. Failing boarding risks taking more damage, and standard gangplanks may not work

Spotlights

Price: 300 gp ea.

-
- **Characteristics:** *Light:* By placing a torch in these mirrored lanterns, light is focused off deck. Each lantern can illuminate off one side of the ship (4 needed for complete coverage). Using a Spotlight eliminates darkness penalties for anything on that side but offers the same benefit to other ships.
 - **Further Upgrades:** *Magic (+200g):* Imbued with the “Light” spell, these lanterns do not require a torch and spring up at a codeword. These are too heavy to be removed from railings and carried.

Thick Walls

Price: 2,000 gp X Ship Size (Unranked=1, 2nd=2, 1st=3)

-
- **Characteristics:** 25% of damage deal to the ship is considered for casualties (Down from 50%)

The Wheel

Improved Mechanism

Price: 1000 gp

-
- **Characteristics:** +1 to Pilot checks

- **Further Upgrades:** *Fine-Tuned (1500g)*: +2 to Pilot checks. Requires Improved Mechanism.

One-handed wheel

Price: 2000 gp

- **Characteristics:** Pilot checks are no longer made at disadvantage if preforming an action on the same time (Only applicable to Dex-based checks).

Weighted Mechanisms

Price: 200 gp

- **Characteristics:** Pilot checks over watch are made at advantage
- **Further Upgrades:** *Arcane Locked (1000g)*: Nighttime Pilot checks have a 75% chance of succeeding even if no one takes them.

Free Spinning

Price: 500 gp

- **Characteristics:** Gain advantage on Pilot Checks to take the About Face action.

Siege Weapon Upgrades

Prices are all for the upgrade specifically- they do not include the weapon they are being applied to.

Ease-of – Access

Price: 500 gp

- **Available Weapons:** L, M, H Cannons
- **Characteristics:** Requires 1 less person to man “efficiently”

Fail-Switch

Price: 50 gp

-
- **Available Weapons** All
 - **Characteristics:** An easy trigger to instantly reduce the weapon to 0hp

Hardy

Price: 100 gp

-
- **Available Weapons** All
 - **Characteristics:** Raise HP by 20, Disadvantage on checks to disable

Precision

Price: 800 gp each time, extra 1k each time past the first (compounding). Culverin Costs x2.

-
- **Available Weapons** All
 - **Characteristics:** +1, +2 and +3 to hit each time taken, respectively. Must take previous bonus before a higher one. So the price of "+2" is the price of "+1 and +2", or 2,600 gp, and you must have already had +1)

Rifling

Price: 600 gp

-
- **Available Weapons** Ca, S and M Cannons
 - **Characteristics:** Increases normal range by 50, and maximum by 25.

Shock Absorbers

Price: 3,000 gp

-
- **Available Weapons** All- Whole side only
 - **Characteristics:** The cannons are seated in springs- Decreases DC of pilot roll due to broadsides by 2 and the other side avoids disadvantage on attacks.

Human Cannonball

Price: 750 gp

- **Available Weapons** H Cannon
- **Characteristics:** Widens the Barrel. Can no longer fire normal shots. Range becomes 30ft. Deals 3d10 fire damage to the "ammunition"

Bronze Cannons

Price: 1,000 gp

- **Available Weapons** All Cannons
- **Characteristics:** A prestigious symbol

Character Options

Backgrounds: Expanded Sailor

The following backgrounds can be added to the normal selection. It is recommended to add these, as they provide skills and abilities that fit a setting the core books do not consider. For example, The RAW Sailor Background (most fitting for a sea faring campaign) wastes its feature if you own a ship. These options look to fill in the gaps left by land centric player options and compliment other aspects of this guide.

All Sailor backgrounds gain the additional feature *Sea Legs*:

Feature: *Sea Legs*

Gain advantage on Dexterity checks and saving throws which are due to the ship's motion.

Sailor: Corsair

Not all sailors are in it for travel, or for the romance. Some are in it for money and to better their lot in life. Others are in it for power and privilege. Either way, having a strong background can help you make your way on the high seas.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Athletics, Perception
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Vehicles (water)
- **Weapon Proficiency:** Firearms

- **Equipment:** A belaying pin, 50 feet of silk rope, a lucky charm, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 12 gp.
-

Feature: *Jolly Roger*

You spent time sailing under an influential symbol or a well known name, and can be associated with a meaningful insignia, for good or for evil. Your association with this symbol or name grants you advantage on intimidation checks if your target recognizes it.

Sailor: Ship's Surgeon

No one wants scurvy, or to find themselves injured several weeks from shore. The most delicate instrument most of the crew has handled is a butcher's knife. A ship's surgeon is the backbone of the ship- a man of the sea and of the cloth. Or of science. Or maybe of desperate necessity. Whichever gets the job done.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Investigation, Medicine
- **Tools:** Herbalism Kit, Vehicles (water)
- **Equipment:** A Healers Kit, common clothes, a quill and ink, and a belt pouch containing 5 gp

Feature: *Medical Intervention*

On a successful Medicine Check with a Healers Kit on an unconscious target, you may spend 5 uses of your kit to heal the creature for 1 HP. (1/LR)

Sailor: Navigator

You have experience navigating ships.
How much of a description do you want?

- **Skills:** Survival, Perception
 - **Tools:** Navigator's tools, Vehicles (water)
 - **Equipment:** Travelers clothes, navigators' tools, a chart, and a pouch containing 10 gp.
-

Feature: *Sense of Direction*

Even at sea, you always know which way North is. You have an eye for the tides, and can further discern whether the tides favor you and how the wind blows (and whether it is likely to change).

Sailor: Explorer

Over your journeys, you sought out incredible sights and experiences. Or perhaps they sought out you. Your life puts fisherman's tales to shame - and may be just as exaggerated.

-
- **Skill Proficiencies:** Nature, Perception
 - **Tool Proficiencies:** Cartographer's tools, Vehicles (water)
 - **Language:** One of your choice
 - **Equipment:** 50 feet of silk rope, a souvenir of somewhere you have been, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 5 gp.
-

Feature: *Discovery*

You have made a journey to a legendary or secret location. (*PHB 134, limited to a location*).

Additional Feats

Should you make use of the optional "Feat" Rule, consider the following options to better craft sea-faring characters.

Deck-Hand

Hard work on the deck of a ship has granted you skills and experience, to the following benefits:

- You gain one tool proficiency related to seafaring.
- You may assist a traveling role while Long Resting (not while sleeping)
- You gain advantage on non-spell based Overboard Saving Throws.
- You may assist up to 2 officer's roles while traveling (up from 1)

Firearm Expert

Thanks to extensive practice with firearms, you gain the following benefits:

- You gain proficiency in firearms, if you don't already have it.
- Being within 5 feet of a hostile creature doesn't impose disadvantage on your ranged attack rolls when using a firearm.
- When you use the Attack action and attack with a one - handed weapon, you can use a bonus action to attack with a loaded firearm that you are holding in your off hand. Normal Two Weapon fighting rules apply.

Pilot

Manning the wheel

is natural to you, with the following benefits:

- If you do not have it already, you gain proficiency in Water Vehicles and Naval Signals (Flairs and Flags)
- If you take a non-pilot action, you do not gain disadvantage on Pilot checks.

Boon:

If a player has a sailor background and takes one of the above feats, they gain an additional boon:

Salty Dog

- You may fulfill up to 3 Officer Positions at the same time

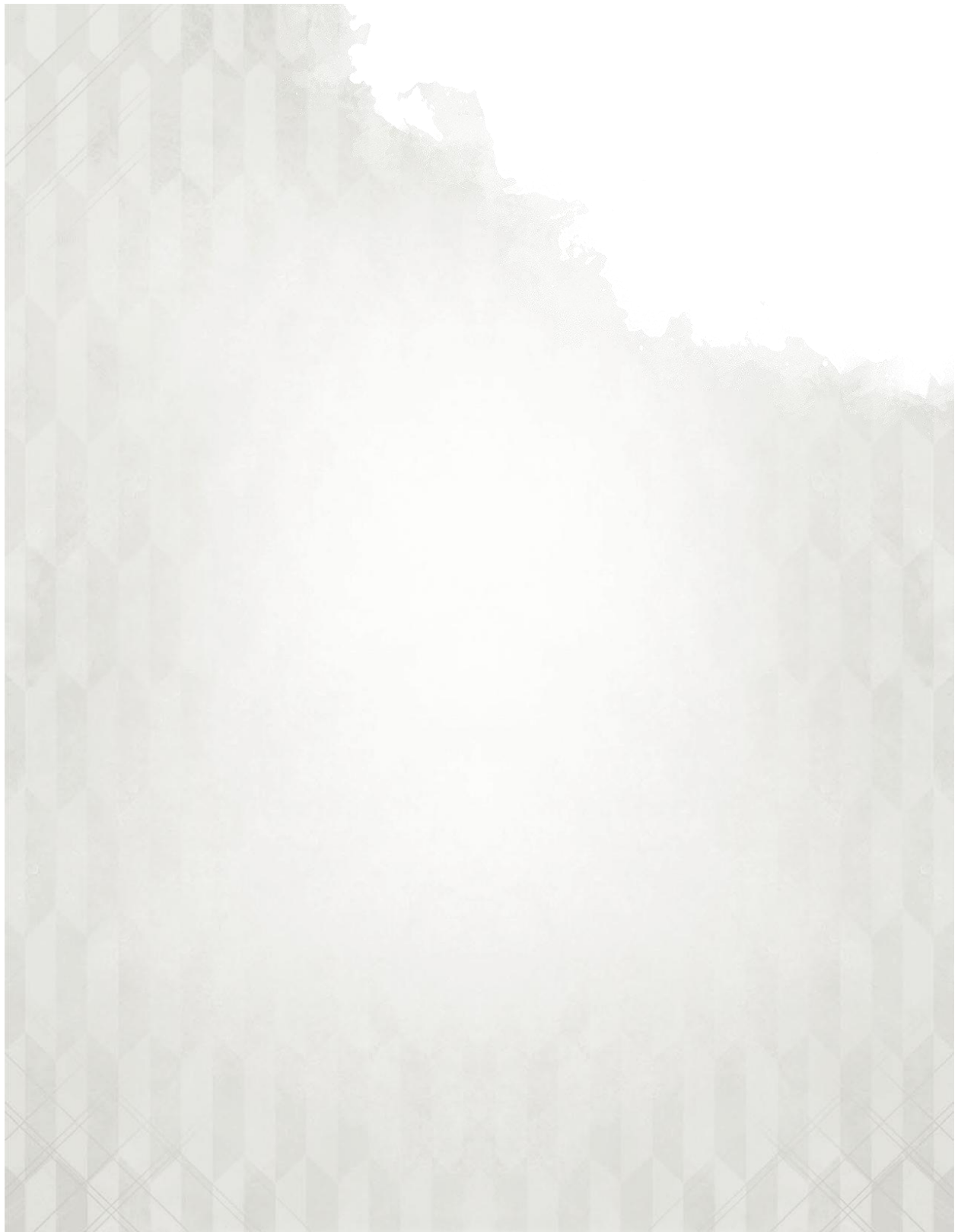
- When you rally someone, they may add your proficiency bonus to their roll.
- You gain a climb speed equal to your walking speed, but only on ladders or rigging. Additionally, you have advantage on Acrobatic / Athletic checks relating to moving across the ship, up or down rigging, and boarding.

DM's: Awarding this boon, as well as the feature *Sea Legs*, should also be considered over the course of a campaign: as a reward, as a result of training, or a passive result of experience on the sea.

Applicable Tool Proficiencies:

- **Brewer's:** Who doesn't like ale? Can also purify water.
- **Calligrapher's:** Analyzing contracts, deals, and maps.
- **Carpenter's:** Can build many of the ship enhancements, may repair ship using proficiency bonus.
- **Cartographer's:** If using a map, add +1 to navigation/pilot travel checks.
- **Jeweler's:** Appraise Treasures and identify mundane loot.
- **Navigator's:** Add proficiency to Navigation checks.
- **Smith's:** Repair misfired cannons, and broken cannons with access to a forge.
- **Tinker's:** Repair cannons that misfire (not able to fix broken cannons).





PART 2

Combat



Combat Overview

Naval Combat is designed to take place on **25 ft. Hexes**. One round of Naval Combat takes 6 seconds, the same as standard combat.

Naval Combat refers to ship - to - ship combat, when officers' positions are active, and ships have initiative. Standard combat refers to classic combat when initiative is taken per the individual.

Before Initiative

1. Determine ship headings and locations
 - Encounters generally won't start if ships are more than 600ft apart (24 hexes)
2. Weather Condition is determined including wave severity and obscurity (night, rain, fog, clear, etc.)
 - The Conditions of the sea can affect pilot checks and some actions.
3. Wind Direction

- If a wind direction was previously decided, use that. If not, you can roll it randomly

4. Clarify Officer Positions

- These positions are central to the design of Naval Combat, giving players authority and actions to take during their ship's turn. Players' officer positions are locked in when initiative is called.
- It is discouraged to allow switching at this point due to it requiring an action to do so.

Ships Roll initiative

5. Add the initiative bonus from the Helmsman

- If you had a Lookout, +1 initiative

6. Every Turn, each Officer may take **One Action**. *No individual turns are taken*, instead each officer may take a single action during the ship's initiative, either a general action or one granted from one of their two officer positions. Players who have the [Arcanist / Militant](#) position are an exception and are free to take full turns on the ship's initiative.

- Officers are free to discuss, plan, and intersperse their actions as they wish. While each officer is responsible for their actions, and have the final say, each action is intended to be a group effort.

7. Besides actions, the ship may use its movement (controlled by the Helmsman). A Pilot Check is made to ensure proper steering.

8. At the end of the turn, [Casualties](#) are calculated for any ships that were damaged

9. Then, the next ship in the initiative goes. Turns continue in this manner until an end condition is reached:

- One side surrenders, or a cease fire is called (these only stop combat if they are accepted).
- A ship is [Boarded](#).
- A ship falls below its [Effective HP](#). Battle is paused at this point. Similarly to surrender, the winner may choose to drop combat or continue.

- A ship reaches 0 HP ([Sinking](#)). Naval Combat may continue here, individual initiative rolled, or something else. It depends on the circumstances, and is up to the DM.

Officer Locations

Officers and crew do not have physical locations in Naval Combat

Naval Combat takes on a collaborative - discovery style of narrative, where every possible option is always available, and the entire ship acts together as a single unit.

In Standard Combat, your physical location defines what you can do. You must move to a lever in order to pull it. In Naval Combat, it is the other way around. Your "location" is defined by the things you do or what happens to you. You take an action, or an action happens to you, and you create an explanation for it.

You do not stay in a "location" that is defined after such an event, but move back to a neutral space until something else happens to you or you act on something. Examples:

- Any officer can assist any other, even if one is a cannoneer and the other is piloting
- Any officer could get hit by any cannonball- no matter where you could have been. If casualties are rolled and you receive damage, then you were in the location a cannonball hit.
- You do not move to a casualty to make a medicine check- by making the check, the casualty is understood to have been next to you or it is assumed you moved to them.

You create a collaborative story from the actions that occur during a turn. Despite not technically being in any location, you can still imagine your character in these places and form a narrative.

The exception to this style of play are the Arcanists / Militants, who follow normal rules. See the [Arcanist](#) section for more information.

Player 1 (Cannoneer / First Mate): *Ok, I'm going to fire the starboard light cannons at the Navy Ship.*

Player 2 (Boatswain / Helmsman): *Wait, we have 2 movement left this turn. Let me bring us in closer so you can get advantage to hit.*

Player 3 (Arcanist / Surgeon): *DM, I used my action to recover a casualty, but I want to use guidance on Player 2 next round. Can I use my movement to make it to the side he was repairing?*

DM: *You can, but since he's just used his pilot action you'll actually need to go to the Helm.*

You can make it this turn. As you climb to the top of the deck you see the Navy ship getting quickly larger, as your pilot madly turns the wheel toward it. A thunder of cannons erupts, filling the air with smoke. Roll for the attacks, Player 1.

Associated Locations in Naval Combat

Arcanists and Militants retain physical locations in Naval Combat. Associated Locations are where you may find other officers, and where you must be located to perform actions granted by that position. Use the "Associated Location" table to determine where you find an officer based on the last officer action they took. An officer who took the pilot action last is at the helm.

However, if that same officer took an action granted by the Boatswain position last, they are instead found on the side of the ship last damaged, and fore / aft closest to the enemy ship. Taking a General action does not move the officer and they are found at the last officer action they took.

Associated Location Table

Last Officer Action

taken	Location
Captain, First Mate, and Quartermaster	Poop Deck
Helmsman	The Helm
Master Gunner	At the cannons they preside over
Cannoneer	At the cannons they preside over or currently man
Surgeon	Side of Ship last damaged, center
Boatswain	Side of ship last damaged, fore / aft

Last Officer Action

taken

Location

based on location of
enemy ship

Arcanist / Militant

Actual location

Crew

Cannon side they are
manning, or main deck if
sailing

Alternate Location Rules: You can use the associated location table to instead track the physical locations of all Officers. They must be in the Associated Location of the position to take an action granted by that position. You should track where shots damage the ship, and where casualties fall. Depending on where a shot hits, certain members may or may not be more likely to take damage should a casualty be rolled.

Leaving the Ship

During Naval Combat, there are several scenarios in which you may leave your ship. As a result of overboard or displacement saving throws, embarking another ship, abandoning a sinking ship or taking a small craft. Leaving the ship during Naval Combat by any means causes you to become your own entity. Roll an initiative and take turns as you would in standard combat. While on your own initiative, you do not have access to Officer Actions. If you rejoin an allied ship, you regain your officer actions and follow normal Naval Combat procedures.

If you go aboard another ship during Naval Combat, they gain individual initiatives and locations same as yourself. However, as they are still on their own ship, they also have access to their Officer Actions.

Movement

Movement is considered as “From the Bow”. You drive the front of the ship, no matter the size. Movement is performed one hex at a time, up to the speed of the ship.

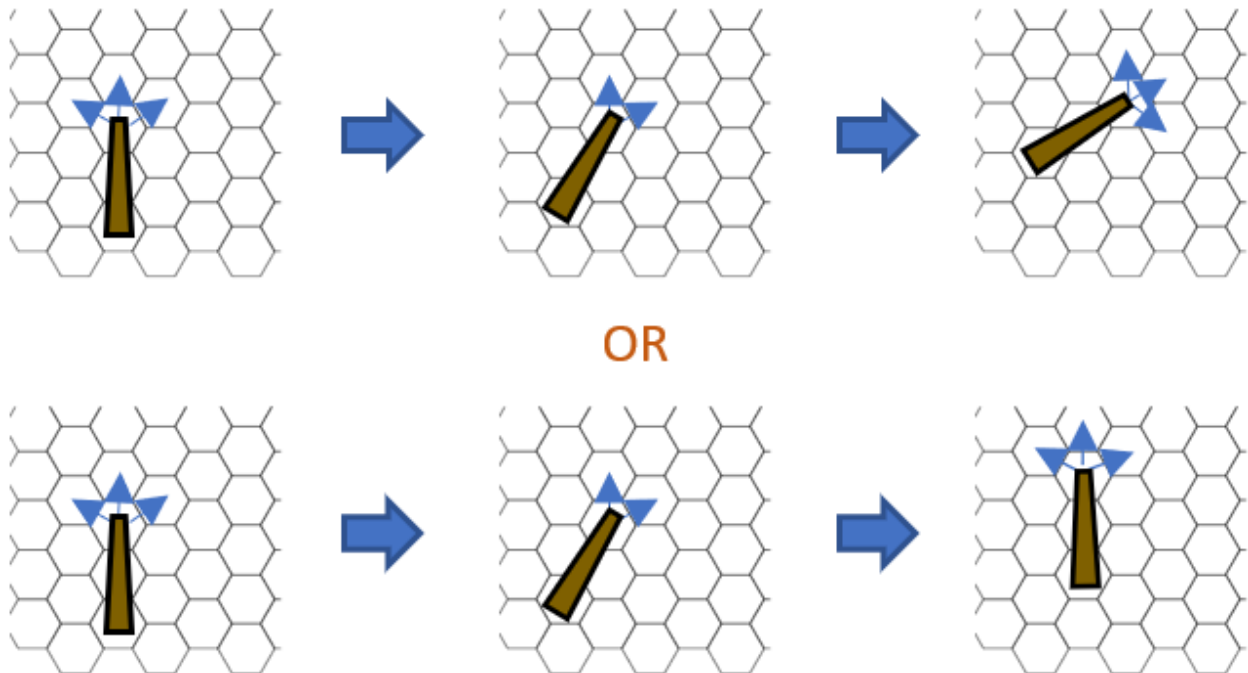
A ship must move at least $\frac{1}{2}$ speed every round, unless it moved $\frac{1}{2}$ speed the previous round, in which case it can stop. (Oars and some enhancements offer immediate stopping)

Turning

Ships must move forward on their turn unless they have stopped. They may move straight forward or forward diagonally. The bow of the ship never moves laterally, only entering hexes that are “Forward” of it from the orientation of the ship (Due to the hex pattern, there will generally be 2 to 3 possible options).

The Aft of the ship follows the bow: the last hex of the ship always inhabiting a hex that ship inhabited prior to the move. In the figure below, the ship inhabits both hexes in the middle when it is diagonal, giving the aft two legal options. If there are multiple possibilities, as when turning in the figure, the aft portion should inhabit the hex opposite the direction of the turn (as illustrated).

Unranked Ships (2-hex long) cannot end a movement facing a vertex – each move, their aft always inhabits the hex their prow began. This allows for tight turns and adds to their high mobility.



Pilot Checks

Pilot checks are made by the Helmsman to successfully maneuver the ship. These Bonus Actions incur disadvantage if the Helmsman has already preformed a non-pilot action on this turn. Pilot checks can use a variety of abilities based on the situation. A table of abilities and examples as to when a DM may call for each is below:

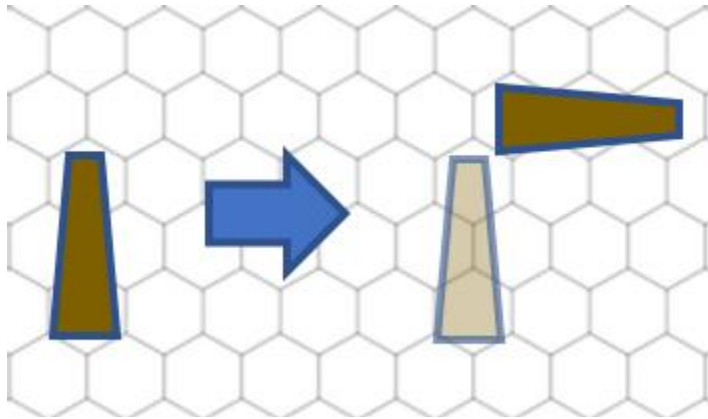
Dexterity	Base Skill: Reacting to things, adjusting course
Strength	Fighting strong waves or current, fighting the forceful displacement of a ship, fighting or keeping a boarding grapple check
Intelligence	Planning a route through sharp rocks, intercepting another ship
Wisdom	Riding with the wind, determining tides

The base DC of these checks is 8, with modifiers due to conditions. Failing a check in Naval Combat will generally cause the hex to cost twice the movement, but sometimes causes the ship to enter a hex adjacent to the one you were moving towards (often with the wind / waves). In other scenarios, the ship may take damage from impacting obstacles or you may fail to gain an advantage you were seeking.

Evasive Maneuver: Come About

When the Helmsman takes this action, A pilot check (as a part of the action) is made for the success of the maneuver (DC 10 + situational modifiers), and a second bonus action pilot check (DC: 10) is made to avoid invoking Overboard Saves. This maneuver uses the full speed of the ship for this turn, and the ship must move ½ speed next turn after the attempt. On a success, the aft most section of ship moves to inhabit the hex forward to the one the bow was previously in, and the bow moves in a straight line over so that the ship extends perpendicular to its former orientation.

Consecutive about faces gain Disadvantage on both pilot checks, and the DC to avoid Overboard Saves is raised by 3 each time. A failure on the initial pilot check causes the maneuver to fail and raises the DC of overboard saves caused by it by 3.



Unrated ships instead rotate 180 degrees when they Come About, so that their stern inhabits the hex directly forward of its starting position, and the bow flips its position in relationship to it. However, attempting the maneuver automatically invokes Overboard Saves on the crew, and the DC for the save gains a +5 (+2 for each consecutive maneuver).

Wind

- **Favorable:** Ships gain a bonus of 1 to their speed when sailing with the wind.
- **Unfavorable:** Movement directly into the wind costs twice the Speed (Difficult Terrain)
 - This penalty is ignored by Unrated and smaller craft

Documentary: Ships cannot move directly against the wind and moving upwind (180° half) is treated as difficult terrain.

Wind direction can be determined randomly by rolling **1d12**:

Wind

d12 Direction

1 North → South

2 NE → SW

3 E → W

d12 Direction

4 SE → NW

5 Favorable

6 No Wind Bonus

d12 Direction

7 No Wind Bonus

8 Unfavorable

9 S → N

10 SW → N

11 EW → E

12 NW → SE

Spell Effects on Movement

In order for wind spells to have an affect on the movement of ships, over half the number of masts must be affected by spells cast at level 2 or higher. Each mast does not need to be affected by the same spell or by the same caster, since many spells only affect enough space to impact one mast at a time. Spells cast at higher level give increasing bonuses, and each bonus compounds on the ones before it.

- A spell cast at Second Level grants the effects of moving with the wind.
- Cast At 3rd level, wind spells help to reduce the effects of the "Strong Wind" weather condition.
- At 5th level, they may allow a ship to move against the wind at no penalty. The travel speed of a ship increases by 1 for every 2 hours of use.
- At 7th level, the spell is sufficient regardless of the number of masts it affects.

Spells which affect water, such as control water, produce the same effects at the same levels, without the need for sails. The spells "Tidal Wave" and "Tsunami" are apt to cause overboard saving throws, but also cause immediate movement effects.

Conditions

Many weather conditions on the sea have effects on movement and combat. Here are some examples with suggested consequences. These, of course, may be combined in situations- the worst storms often cause several at once

Weather / Ocean Conditions

Condition Effect

Fog	+1 DC of Int. based pilot checks, Disadvantage on Asses actions
	Disv. On Int and Dex based pilot checks
Heavy Fog	Disadvantage on assess actions Disadvantage on attack rolls further than 100ft
Heavy Rain	Disadvantage on Overboard Saves
	+ 2 speed when sailing with wind Failed Pilot checks cause ship to move downwind
Heavy Wind	Disadvantage on evasive maneuvers Pilot checks may use STR.
Choppy Waves	+1 to Pilot checks
	Str Pilot checks common
Large Waves	Lair action: Pilot check to avoid Overboard Saves Disadvantage on Boarding and acrobatics to board.

Condition Effect

Overboard Saving Throws. Ship is
Tidal Wave immediately moved up to 300ft. in
the direction of the wave

Whirlpool Pilot check DC is +5, failures or no
check cause the ship to drift
toward the center. Moving Counter
to the whirlpool is Difficult Terrain,
while moving with
it gives +3 speed.

Overboard

Some actions and interactions have a chance to require dexterity saves from the crew to avoid losing their footing or, at worst, falling overboard. These "Overboard Saves" follow a Beat-By Scale, where the higher you roll than the DC, the better your result, while rolling further beneath the DC produces worse results.

If you have more than 5 crew (non-officers), instead of rolling separately for each of them, a crew check should be made on the "Crew Overboard Save Chart", while Officers still roll individually. Spells or other effects / actions which displace people follow a slightly altered system, which can be found in the "Magic" section ([p. 31](#)).

What may cause overboard Saving Throws:

- "Come About" Action, Evasive Maneuver Action, Ramming/Being Rammed
- Weather Conditions (Strong Waves, Heavy Rain)
- Broadsides
- And more. Don't be afraid to rock the boat!

Captain Hook Mode:

- Naval Combat: Failures always result in disadvantage on any action taken next turn
- Crew is assumed to save unless a Natural 1 was the cause of this check, in which case 1 crew member falls overboard.

Overboard Save Charts

Naval Combat

Result	Effect
--------	--------

Success by 5 or More	You keep your footing and can help another, giving them advantage on the check.
----------------------	---

Success	Keep your footing and receive no penalties.
---------	---

Failure by 9 or less	Any action you take next turn has disadvantage as you scramble back in place.
----------------------	---

Failure by 10 or More	Make a secondary Dex save (Same DC). On a failure, you fall overboard. On a success, you may choose to stay on by giving another character disadvantage on this check, and you cannot take an action next round.
-----------------------	--

Standard Combat

Result	Effect
--------	--------

Success	Save
---------	------

Failure by 9 or less	Move 5 feet in the appropriate direction (Chosen by DM). If this moves you off the ground you are standing on, move to the edge and fall prone instead.
----------------------	---

Failure by 10 or More	Move 15 feet in the direction the DM chooses. If this moves you off the ground you are standing on, make a Dex save (Same DC). On a success, fall prone at the edge. Otherwise, fall overboard.
-----------------------	---

Crew Overboard Save Chart

Result	Effect
--------	--------

Success by 5 or More	All Save
----------------------	----------

Success	All Skilled save, and 1d4-1 unskilled fall prone That many crew may not be used next round
---------	---

Failure by 7 or less	All Skilled Save, and 1d4 unskilled fall prone That many crew can be used next round. Additionally, 1 who fell prone instead falls overboard
----------------------	--

Result**Effect**

Failure by 8 or More

1d4-2 Crew Fall overboard. If the save roll was 1, one of them is a skilled hireling





Damage

Targets

In Naval Combat, all types of damage - may it be cannons, spells, or individual attacks - have a specific selection of targets. Dealing damage to the ship or rigging deals damage to the associated HP and may also cause casualties among the crew. If an attack might affect more than one target (Such as an AoE spell), then ½ damage is dealt to anything other than the intended target. The same target cannot be affected more than once from a single attack. The targets are as follows:

-
- **The Ship:** Targeting the ship deals damage to the ship's HP.
The Hull is the target of any attack against the ship. Damage done to the hull must succeed the damage threshold of the ship (per attack). Attacks which target the ship add to the Casualty Damage an amount equal to half of what they dealt to the ship. With the exception "Raking Fire", attacks to the hull always hit the side closest to the attack, either port or starboard. The deck is the same as the hull in all respects, but attacks against the crew or specific targets might damage it specifically.
-
- **The Rigging** describes the sails, masts, and other aspects of the ship related to movement. Attacks against the rigging are made with disadvantage **and** -3 to the attack roll. Damage to the rigging impacts the [Rigging HP](#), affecting the movement of the ship as it decreases. There is no damage threshold to attacking the rigging, but no damage done to it is considered in the casualty roll.
-
- **The Crew:** The Crew uses the AC of the ship. Attacks against the crew are made with disadvantage, and the crew cannot be targeted if you already have disadvantage on the attack. With some exceptions, attacks targeting the crew do not deal damage to the Ship's HP, but add their full damage to the Casualty Damage, which might increase the number of casualties rolled at the end of the turn.
-
- **A Specific Target:** Targeting specific targets incurs disadvantage on the attack roll and may incur cover penalties at DM's discretion. A specific target is anything not listed above, including specific people or things. In this case, the AC and HP are that of the target, and in most cases does not affect casualty rolls, Ship HP, or Rigging Hp.

Field of Fire

In Naval Combat, the only physical location siege weapons are given is which side they are on- their position forward to aft is not tracked. Siege Weapons installed on ships are large installments which cannot easily be moved and have a limited turning radius. Due to the location of a target, the ship may not be able to fire on a target, or not do it well. The area a ship is able to fire on is known as it's Field of Fire.

Ships have two parts to their Field of Fire: A central cone in which all cannons of a side have a clear shot on a target, known as the **Full Field**, and a second field, slightly larger, in which the cannons may not have as clear of a shot. In this area, the **Half Field**, the target has Half-Cover (+2 AC).

These cones follow similar rules to magic: if a majority of a hex is in a field, it counts as being within it. And if part of the target also inhabits that hex, it counts as being within it. Having a clear shot on any part of a target removes the bonus it might otherwise receive from the half field. Outside of the Field of Fire, the target has Full Cover and cannot be targeted.

-
- **Examples:**
 - If a ship is only touching the Half Field on the port side, it has Half Cover from all cannon attacks from port, and full cover from cannons on the starboard side.
 - If a ship is touching the Half Field on both sides of the ship, then both sides will be able to fire (but target benefits from Half Cover)

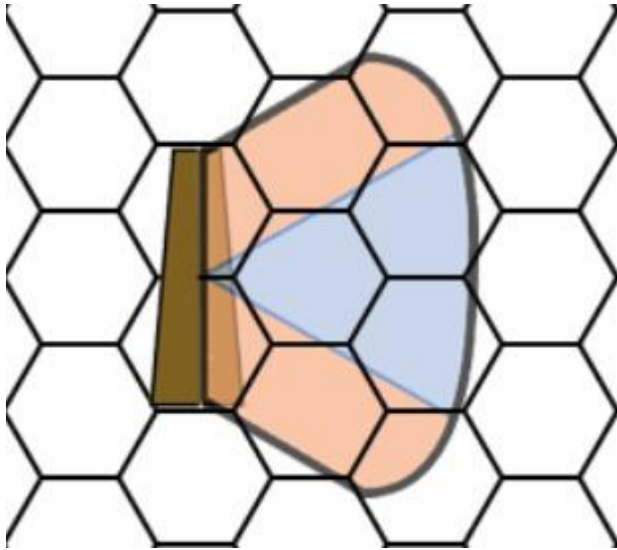
Field Templates

Each ship has a slightly different field due to their size. Use the templates provided in the "References" section to determine the range at different orientations. Blue Signifies Full Field, while orange indicates the Half Field.

To use a template, align the sides with the bow and stern of the ship (or the edges of the hexes the ship inhabits) and align the origin of the template at the midline of the ship. Below are examples of how the templates work with each class of ship.

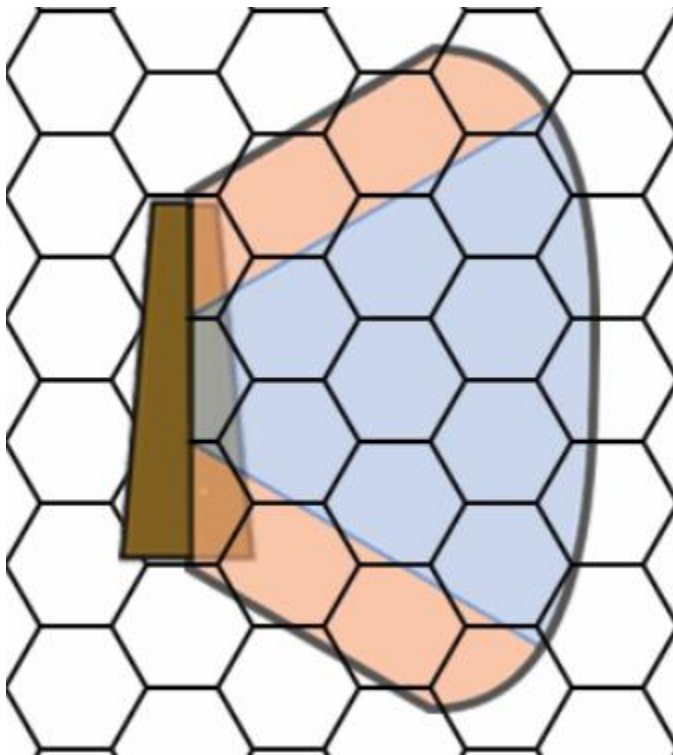
These Templates are only guidelines! If the DM feels confident with the fields, there is no need to use them.

Unrated:

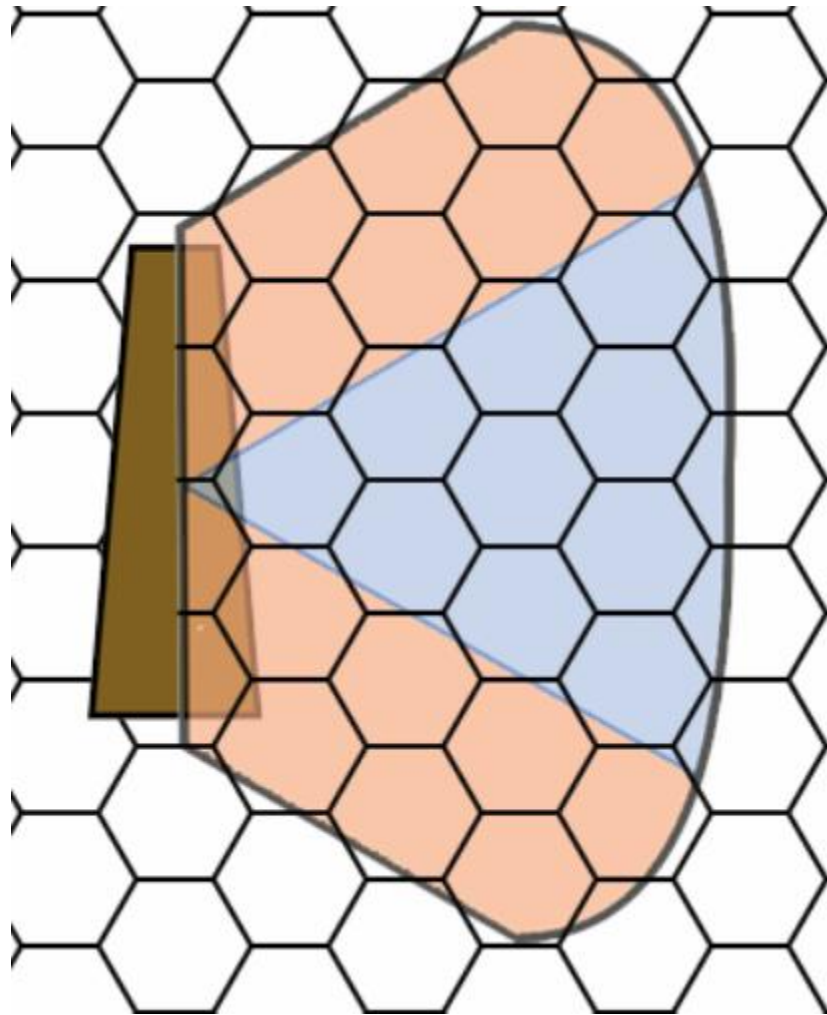


2nd Rate:

Second Rate ships have a similar origin as Unrated with a slightly wider spread, Full field starts at 2 hexes wide. Again, the half field is a single row of hexes beside the full field.

**1st Rate:**

First Rate ships have an even larger field as their half field is 2 rows wide.



Bow / Stern Cannons

One Enhancement offered to ships is the installation of Bow / Stern Cannon Ports. Should these be installed it counts as it's own side. Weapons and cannoneers must be appropriately allocated to them. The hexes directly fore or aft of the ship are fully covered by the cannons, and they use the "unrated" template regardless of ship class.

Broadside

As an action, The Master Gunner can call for a Broadside (Recharge 5-6).

Broadside: Choose one side of the ship. Each siege weapon on that side may immediately attack, at disadvantage, a single target sized large or larger that is within its normal range. They may make this attack *even if they are in the middle of loading*. For every "1" that is rolled on a damage die, you may roll an additional damage die of that weapon ("Exploding Dice"). You may choose to use "Special Shot" within a broadside, but extra damage from these do not gain the "Exploding Dice" property.

Siege Weapons on other sides have disadvantage to hit on the turn this action is used.

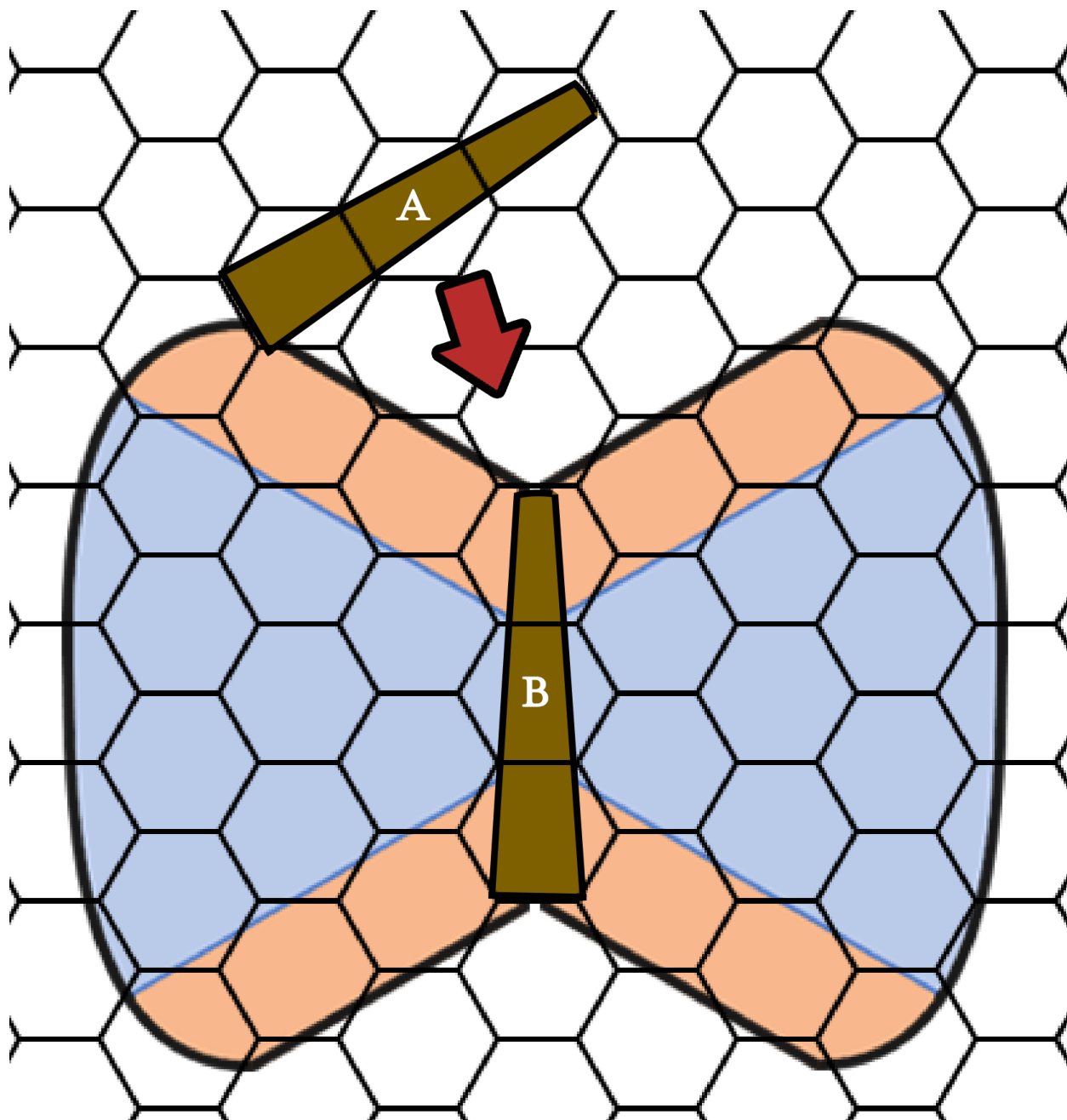
After this action, every weapon that participated must restart it's load time. The side chosen cannot broadside again until every cannon that fired has naturally gone through a their load time, regardless of broadside's recharge state.

The broadside also affects the ship as a whole. The Helmsman has disadvantage on their next pilot check. When either taking or receiving a broadside action, there may be a Pilot Check Save called. On a fail, Overboard Saves may be called for ($DC = 6 + \text{Modifiers}$).

Raking Fire

When your location is fore or aft of a ship and outside its Port and Starboard Fields of Fire, you target either the Bow (if you're ahead) or Stern (if you're astern) with ranged weapon attacks. "Raking Fire" are attacks fired at these locations, longways down a ship and have potential to inflict greater damage. The damage bonus is only ever awarded when in the appropriate location (specifically targeting the bow or stern normally does not suffice).

As long as you are in the appropriate location, you may roll one additional weapon damage die when determining the damage from ranged weapon attacks which target the ship. This bonus applies to any ranged weapon attacks, including those as a part of broadsides or using special shots. The bonus damage does not apply to attacks made against any targets other than "The Ship" (see "Targeting"), and may be denied by certain ship enhancements. Below, Ship "A" has gained the raking fire damage bonus by targeting the bow of ship "B".



Hit Points

Ships possess 2 Hit point pools: **Ship** and **Rigging**. There is also the **Casualty Damage**.

Ship HP describes the status of the ship, and act much like the HP of a creature. When it hits 0, the ship begins sinking. One half of the damage dealt to the ship is added to the casualty damage for the turn. Ships also contain a value known as the **Effective HP**. While

they aren't sinking, ships below this value have been nearly destroyed, and their functions are limited.

Rigging HP describes the masts, sails, and steering units of a ship. Damaging these do not cause the ship to sink, but as the HP drops, sanctions are put on the ship to represent its limited sailing capabilities. Unlike creature HP, Rigging HP has a series of effects based on the amount remaining, besides just hitting 0.

Ship Hit points

Going Beneath Effective HP

As long as a ship's hit points are below its Effective HP, the following penalties are incurred:

- Disadvantage on all rolls related to Officer Actions
- Disadvantage on all Siege Weapon Attacks

Sinking

When a ship is brought to 0 hit points, it is considered sinking. The ship's speed and travel speed become 0. It is recommended to roll initiative regardless of combat status.

All penalties from being beneath effective HP persist, and actions to repair the ship automatically fail.

The ship becomes completely submerged in 1d6+2 rounds. Once submerged, the ship sinks 120 feet per round.

While Sinking, the ship is considered difficult terrain. On initiative count 20, everyone must make an overboard saving throw. Besides the normal failure results, characters may take bludgeoning damage, be restrained by debris, or other ill effects unique to the situation.

Rigging Hit Points

Each ship has associated with it a Rigging HP value, representing the masts, sails, and steering units. Each Mast on a ship adds **40** total Rigging HP. As these take damage, movement effects occur based on amount of HP remaining. This HP can be repaired the same as Ship HP.

HP

Remaining Condition

51% or More	Full Effectiveness
-------------	--------------------

HP

Remaining Condition

50% - 26% No bonus with wind

25% - 11% No bonus or penalties from wind
1/2 Speed, 1/2 Travel Speed

10% or Lower No Bonus or penalty from Wind.
Speed equals 1, Travel Speed equals 1

Casualties

At the end of each turn, casualties must be calculated for every ship based on the Casualty Damage they took that turn.

You begin every turn with 0 Casualty Damage, which increases after every hit which adds damage to it. Attacks that target the ship add an amount of damage equal to half the damage they dealt to the ship, while attacks which target the crew have their full damage added. The casualty damage is the sum total over a single turn.

Some attacks specify that they do not affect this total, and some others cause immediate casualties and are therefore not considered a second time. At the end of the turn, consult the following chart to determine the results:

Casualty Chart

Tier Casualty Damage Casualties

0 <30 No Casualties

1 30 - 39 1 Casualty

2 40 - 69 1d4-1 (minimum 1)

3 70 - 119 1d4 (minimum 1)

4 120 - 159 1d4+1

Tier Casualty Damage Casualties

5 160 - 199 1d4+2

6 ≥200 1d4+3

Example: In a turn, a ship is hit by 3 Light cannon hits (11 dmg each) and a medium cannon (25 dmg) targeting the hull, while a javelin hits targeting the crew (6 dmg). The the ship takes 58 HP damage, and 35 casualty damage, so 1 casualty occurs.

For every casualty, a non-skilled crew member becomes unconscious but stable, and is no longer able to be used to man cannons, sail, etc. The DM selects (or randomly determines) who this is, and it should be noted that they cannot be used. After determining casualties for a turn, your casualty damage resets to 0 for the next one.

You have a chance to recover casualties during combat through certain actions including the Surgeon's "Medical Intervention" or general healing spells, as well as the Casualty Recovery roll at the end of combat.

Officer Casualties

If an attack that was targeting the ship or crew scores a critical hit, it hits a PC/ Skilled Hireling/ Combat Unit on that ship for damage equal to their level. If they do not have a level, their CR can be used. Who is hit is decided by the DM or rolled randomly. The attack does damage to its intended target as normal, but no damage from the attack, regardless of its target, is considered for casualty damage.

Crewless Casualty Rolls

If you have **6** or fewer people available and no unskilled hirelings available, end of round casualties are replaced with Officer Casualties. If you take casualty damage during a round, roll a 1d6. If the number rolled is lower than the tier of damage the ship took that round (see the Casualty Chart), an officer or combat unit takes damage equal to their level.

Casualty Recovery

Casualties are assumed to remain “stable” until the end of combat. At that point, a medicine check can be made to attempt to save them (must be proficient in Medicine and have a Healer’s kit or another combination of an appropriate skill and kit). Crew who went overboard are not counted in this roll and need to be dealt with on a case by case basis.

This check is made at the end of all combats that string together- So if Naval Combat transforms into standard combat, it is to be made at the end of standard. While the roll

must be made then, the implications as to time and space (whether you must be on the ship, how long this takes, etc.) are up to the DM. For every Crew you succeed on, remove one use of your Kit. The medicine check DC is equal to **8 + the number of casualties** and is rolled on the degree of success "Casualty Recovery" table.

To use the help action on this check, you must have proficiency with Medicine or an Applicable Skill. Each additional helper past the first gives a +1 to the roll.

You may take disadvantage on the roll to gain a second check, with advantage, to save a specific casualty. Those who took the help action may choose which roll to help, but can only grant their bonus to one.

Casualty Recovery

Roll	Result
------	--------

Succeed by 10 or more	You masterfully save all casualties. They are incapacitated for 2 hours and suffer no exhaustion.
-----------------------	--

Succeed by less than 10	You save all the casualties: They are incapacitated for 6 hours, and upon awakening suffer 1 point of exhaustion
-------------------------	--

Fail	One crew member is unable to be saved for every number below the DC you rolled, maximum loss of 5. You decide whom. Survivors are incapacitated for 18 hours, and upon waking suffer 2 points of exhaustion.
------	--

Fail with a Nat. 1	There are no survivors: Shaken, you and anyone who assisted take 1 point of exhaustion.
--------------------	---

Documentary Mode: DC = 10 + Number of Casualties

Magic

With the multitude of interactions and new mechanics introduced when fighting on or between ships, some additional rules needed to be in place to expedite magic and create situations with predictable outcomes.

General Rulings:

- **Ground:** Water is **NOT** considered ground. Exceptions can of course be made per DM fiat. The deck of a ship **IS** considered ground, but not "earth", "soil", "stone", etc.
 - **Exceptions:** *Erupting Earth* and *Bones of the Earth* cannot target ships.
- A ship, and any part affixed to it permanently like a mast is considered one huge / gargantuan water vehicle, and not an object for most cases.
- For how spells can affect the movement of ships, see [Spell Effects on Movement](#)

Magic in Naval Combat

Like all other damage, spells follow the targeting and damaging rules outlined in [Targets](#). When targeting anything, simply roll damage. Assume no saves for half damage and apply the damage rolled to the targets as instructed in the "Targets" section.

Area of Effect (AOE) Spells: (*Wall of Fire*, *Cloudkill*): When targeting the crew with a spell cast at or above the 3rd level that has at least a 10ft radius (or equivalent coverage), roll the damage and use double that when calculating casualties. If the spell maintains over multiple rounds, this bonus damage is only applied on the first round the spell is active. If an AOE spell does not meet the requirements above, roll the damage and add that to the casualty damage for the round.

AOE spells that are not connected to the ground (*Flaming Sphere*, *Stinking Cloud*) do not move with a ship. They remain where they are cast unless moved by the caster. They will only cause damage if an appropriate amount remains on the ship.

AOE spells that are cast to the ground (*Wall of Fire*) move with a ship, remaining where they were cast in reference with the ship, moving as it moves.

Magic in Standard Combat

AOE spells that are not connected to the ground (*Flaming Sphere*, *Stinking Cloud*, *Call Lightning*) do not move with a ship. They remain where they are cast. In standard combat, this means they will “move” across the battlefield as the ship moves beneath them.

AOE spells that are cast to the ground (*Wall of Fire*) move as a ship moves, remaining stationary in respect to the battlefield.

Even in Standard Combat, Spells (or any attack) may hit the ship and damage it if they beat the damage threshold.





Displacement Effect Saves

In both Naval and Ship-bound Standard Combat, spells and effects which incur displacement effects follow a beat-by scale as opposed to the normal save mechanics. Examples of these effects are *Thunderwave*, or the **Shove** action. The save rolls against these effects are rolled on the Displacement Save Charts against the save DC. In Naval Combat, the specific effects of the spell or action are replaced with general penalties while their damage contributes to casualty rolls as normal. For information on falling overboard, see "Leaving the Ship".

Determining Targets

- **Naval Combat:** For every 10 x 10 ft area affected on the ship, 2 people are considered “affected” by the displacement effect (Max 8, Minimum of 1). This means a spell that affects a 5x20 area affects 2.
- **Standard Combat:** There are no changes to the the normal rules regarding who is affected by a spell or effect. The only change to displacement effects in standard combat is the save being rolled on the "Standard Combat Displacement Save" chart.

Naval Combat Displacement Save

Result	Effect
Success by 5 or More	You save and can help another- giving them advantage on the check.
Success	You Save

Result**Effect**

Failure by 4 or less

You fail the check: Any action you take next turn has disadvantage as you scramble back in place. This replaces the displacement effects.

Failure by 5 or More

Make a secondary Dex save, DC equal to the first.
On a success, you may choose to stay aboard by giving another disadvantage on the check, and you may take no action next round.
On a failure, you fall overboard.

Standard Combat Displacement Save**Result****Effect**

Success

You Save

Failure by 4 or less

Follow the directions of the effect.
If this moves you off the ground you are standing on, and not onto different ground (your ship, another ship, land, etc.) stop moving at the edge of the furthest point of land and fall prone instead.

Failure by 5 or More

Follow the full, unchanged directions of the effect

Crew Displacement Save Chart

Naval Combat Only, Make a Single Roll. For each Skilled Crew affected, add +1 to the roll

Result**Effect**

Success by 5 or More

All Save

Success

All Skilled save, and half the affected unskilled fall prone
That many fewer crew may be utilized next round

Result

Effect

Failure by 7 or less

All Skilled Save, and 3 out of 4 unskilled fall prone
That many fewer crew may be used next round
Additionally, 1 which fell prone instead falls overboard

Failure by 8 or More

2 out of 3 affected unskilled crew fall overboard
Affected Skilled crew must roll on the normal chart at disadvantage.

Boarding

Boarding describes the specific strategy of forcing standard combat by coming side by side another ship and grappling it using a "Boarding Bonus" as the modifier for the contest.

Boarding is not the only means of invading another ship, despite other methods still resulting in a ship being "boarded". [Leaving the ship](#) gives more information on what occurs using other tactics.

As in Naval Combat, Unskilled Hirelings are not to participate in any part of boarding. Boarding and assisting it are restricted to those who can take actions in Naval Combat, such as officers and combat units.

Boarding Procedure

1. **On their ship's turn, The Captain, Quartermaster, or First Mate takes the 'Board' free action** To take the boarding action, the two ships must be side by side and facing the same direction. Their ship becomes the "Offensive" ship, and the targeted ship becomes "Defensive"
2. **Officers participate in the boarding.** Offensive ship Officers, except the Helmsman, may take actions as normal, including actions which help raise the boarding bonus or actions to leave the ship. The helmsman must save their action to make the boarding check at the end of the turn.

The goal of those assisting is to increase the **Boarding Bonus** by using grappling hooks, harpoons or spells. **A bonus of at least +1 is needed or else the boarding automatically fails.**

Here is a collection of what may give a boarding bonus, and a reminder of what offensive boarding bonus they give. The location of the mechanics is also given.

Action	Source	Bonus
Grappling Hook	Items	+1
Harpoon	Ammunition	+3
Hooked Gangplank	Ship Items, Gangplank Upgrade	+1
Hooked Ram	Ship Enhancements	+5

Below are examples of spells that may increase the boarding bonus. This is not an exhaustive list, and the listed bonuses are suggestions which may differ on a case by case basis. Some spells may not add a direct bonus but influence the check in other ways.

Spell	Bonus
Grasping Vine	+1
Web	+2
Bigby's Hand	+3
Arcane Hand	+3

Instead of helping, you may wish to immediately move onto the targeted ship. The "Boarding Party" should take the "Ready" action to move across using their method of choice with the trigger "when the boarding succeeds". Using them immediately, instead of holding them, could result in being stranded.

- Those using rope swings, jumping, etc. will make acrobatics checks. On a success, you choose where to land (must be within 10 feet of the side boarded over) and move onto the boarded ship. On a failure, you may not make it, swing back, or even fall.
- If using a gangplank, laying it down is an action- moving across it will requires movement on your turn.

The Boarding Check

3. **The "Boarding Check" is made by the Offensive Helmsman, contested with a pilot check from the Defensive Helmsman.** At the end of the ship's turn, the offensive ship needs at least +1 to their boarding bonus. If not, their turn ends. If they do, the Helmsman makes a "Boarding Check" as their action, adding their proficiency bonus and the Boarding Bonus to the roll. This check is contested by a pilot check from the helmsman of the defensive ship, using an ability modifier of their choice.

On a failure, the ships are not grappled. The offensive ship's turn ends, and Naval Combat continues. You may continue to attempt to board on your ship's turns so long as the conditions are met.

On a successful boarding check, the boarding succeeds and both ships are in a modified grapple, detailed in "The Boarding". If an action was held to move onto the ship, it is taken now.

Naval Combat ends and individual initiative is rolled for everyone. Begin Standard Combat.

The Boarding

While in this variant grapple, the speed of both ships drops to 0. Instead, they each move forward one hex at a time in the direction they were heading, potentially listing. The ships stay 10ft away from each other, and neither is able to move freely until the grapple is broken (the boarding bonus reduced to 0), at which point both ships may move freely. As long as the grapple is maintained, neither ship has access to officer actions except the Helmsman. Cannons and other features of the ships are still functional but must be manned or used on an individual basis since unskilled hirelings are not considered present during standard combat.

Each round, the offensive helmsman must keep the grapple active using either their Action or Bonus Action. The ships drift apart 5 ft. each round on Initiative count 1 if this bonus action was not taken. This drifting does not occur if the Boarding Bonus is greater than or equal to **+ 5**, as the ships are assumed to stay together. The ships start at 10ft away from each other and move apart from there. Gangplanks are destroyed if the distance between ships is longer than their length. Grappling hooks and harpoons are likewise rendered ineffective if the ships drift apart further than their normal range.

Breaking the Boarding

The grapple ends if the boarding bonus is reduced to 0.

Aboard the defensive ship, the "use object" action can be taken on the wheel of a ship to attempt to immediately break the grapple as an action, or as a bonus action if performed

by the Helmsman. This pilot check follows the guidelines in the "Helmsman" section, including being at disadvantage if a non - pilot action was already taken that same turn. If the offensive ship remains piloted, this may be contested the same as the initial check. Otherwise, it is a pilot check with a DC of **10 + the offensive boarding bonus**. On a success, you are able to wrestle the ship out of the range of whatever methods the opponent used to achieve their boarding bonus, breaking ropes and snapping gangplanks, automatically reducing the bonus to 0. Only one check to break the boarding maybe taken per round.

The defending or offensive ship may also end the grapple by manually reducing the boarding bonus to 0. This can be done by directly negating the means the offensive ship is using to increase their bonus. Possibilities, depending on what the offensive ship has in place, include removing the grappling hooks, cutting ropes connecting the ships, pushing the ships far enough that these break, etc. These actions may also be held during Naval Combat so they can be done as a reaction as soon as standard combat begins. Many spells hold potential to affect the boarding state, offensive or defensively, such as pushing a ship or controlling the opposing pilot.

Ending the Grapple

As soon as the boarding bonus equals 0, the grapple ends, and the fight on deck either continues or Naval Combat is resumed. In most cases, Naval Combat is resumed with several officers disembarked and aboard another ship - See [Leaving the Ship](#) for more information. When reentering Naval Combat, the ships should be next to each other and facing the same way, and pilots should re-roll the ships' initiatives. If there are other ships in the fight or officers still disembarked, keep those initiatives and add the new ship initiatives to the initiative order.

References

Ship Blocks

1st Rate Ships

Merchant

1st Rate, 35,000 gp

- **Armor Class** 8
 - **Hit Points** 700
 - **Rigging HP** 120
 - **Speed** 2
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
25	50	10/26	40

- **Max Crew** 70
 - **Storage** 6,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 10
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Standard.**
 - **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement
-

Carrack

1st Rate, 50,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 700
 - **Rigging HP** 120
 - **Speed** 2
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
27	50	10/26	40

- **Max Crew** 70
 - **Storage** 6,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 10
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Boarding.** The Carrack has advantage on all boarding contests
 - **Live Oak Hull** Includes the enhancement "Live Oak Hull" on all sides.
 - **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement
-
-

East Indiaman

1st Rate, 40,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 8

- **Hit Points** 700
- **Rigging HP** 120
- **Speed** 2

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
-----------------------------	-------------------------	---------------------------	--------------------------

25	50	10/26	40
----	----	-------	----

- **Max Crew** 70
- **Storage** 12,000 lbs.
- **Davit Slots** 10
- **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison

Characteristics

- **Heavy.** Takes 2 turns at 1/2 speed before it is able to stop
- **Cargo.** Has 2x carrying capacity
- **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement

Man - O - War

1st Rate, 70,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 8
 - **Hit Points** 725
 - **Rigging HP** 120
 - **Speed** 2
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
25	50	20/50	40

-
- **Max Crew** 100
 - **Storage** 6,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 10
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Battery.** Double normal number of guns
 - **Expanded Quarters.** Enough room for 100 crew.
 - **Cumbersome.** Disadvantage on evasive maneuvers.
 - **Resilient.** 700 HP.
 - **Large Hull.** May only sail in the deepest of water (cannot dock).
 - **Fortress.** If Attacked from within 50ft, gain a **+1 bonus to AC**
-

Galleon

1st Rate, 40,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 8
 - **Hit Points** 700
 - **Rigging HP** 120
 - **Speed** 3
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
---------------------	-----------------	-------------------	------------------

25	50	10/26	40
----	----	-------	----

-
- **Max Crew** 70
 - **Storage** 6,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 10
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Included Gangplanks.** Comes with a Gangplank with the "Corvus" Upgrade.
 - **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement
 - **Live Oak Bow.** Has the "Live Oak Hull" enhancement to the bow.
-

Guineaman

1st Rate, 40,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 8
 - **Hit Points** 650
 - **Rigging HP** 120
 - **Speed** 2
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
---------------------	-----------------	-------------------	------------------

25	50	10/26	40
----	----	-------	----

-
- **Max Crew** 70
 - **Storage** 6,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 10
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Public.** Instead of rooms, one large lower deck
 - **Mobile.** Speed: 3
 - **Sturdy.** Advantage on pilot check saves as a result of Broadsides
 - **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement
-

Pink

1st Rate, 37,000 gp

- **Armor Class** 8
 - **Hit Points** 700
 - **Rigging HP** 120
 - **Speed** 2
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
25	50	10/26	40

- **Max Crew** 70
- **Storage** 6,000 lbs.

- **Davit Slots** 10
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Low Draft** May move through shallow waters
- **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement

2nd Rate Ships

Brig

2nd Rate, 20,000 gp

- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 500
 - **Rigging HP** 80
 - **Speed** 3
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
------------------	--------------	----------------	---------------

20	25	4/8	15
----	----	-----	----

- **Max Crew** 40
 - **Storage** 4,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 6
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Interceptor.** Daily Travel Speed calculated as if one class up (1st Class)
- **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement

Schooner

2nd Rate, 20,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 500
 - **Rigging HP** 80
 - **Speed** 2
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
20	25	4/8	15

- **Max Crew** 40
 - **Storage** 4,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 6
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Low Draft.** May move in shallow water
- **Cumbersome.** -1 Speed
- **Sleuth** More difficult to be tracked
- **Restriction.** Cannot be outfitted with oars.

- **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement

Frigate

2nd Rate, 23,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 500
 - **Rigging HP** 80
 - **Speed** 2

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
------------------	--------------	----------------	---------------

20	25	4/8	15
----	----	-----	----

- **Max Crew** 40
- **Storage** 4,000 lbs.
- **Davit Slots** 6
- **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison

Characteristics

- **Large.** Largest in Class
 - **Cumbersome.** -1 Speed
 - **Unyielding** When being grappled, offensive ship requires +8 Boarding Bonus to avoid drifting when no action is taken (up from 5).
 - **Grappler** Advantage to maintain boarding (Not initial checks)
-

Carvel

2nd Rate, 22,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 500
 - **Rigging HP** 80
 - **Speed** 3
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
20	25	4/8	15

- **Max Crew** 40
 - **Storage** 5,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 6
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Smuggling Hull.** Secret Storage Room. +1000 lbs carrying capacity, DC 15 Hidden door to locate.
- **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement

Clipper

2nd Rate, 28,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 500
 - **Rigging HP** 80
 - **Speed** 3
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
20	75	4/8	15

-
- **Max Crew** 40
 - **Storage** 4,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 6
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Extra Rigging.** 3 Masts (+40 Rigging HP)
 - **Increased Speed.** +1 Speed
 - **Fragile.** Effective HP: 75
 - **Crow's Nest.** Has 2 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement
-

Galley

2nd Rate, 23,000 gp

- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 500
 - **Rigging HP** 80
 - **Speed** 3
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
20	25	4/8	15

- **Max Crew** 40
- **Storage** 4,000 lbs.

- **Davit Slots** 6
- **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison

Characteristics

- **Manual Outfit.** Includes the Enhancements: "Oars" as well as "Oar Ports"
- **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement

Junk

2nd Rate, 24,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 500
 - **Rigging HP** 100
 - **Speed** 3

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
20	25	4/8	15

-
- **Max Crew** 40
 - **Storage** 4,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 6
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Rudder.** A Large, Pronounced Rudder (+20 Rigging HP)

- **Responsive.** Advantage on evasive maneuvers
- **Radius.** When the about face action is taken, the ship does not need to move forward of the prow, and instead lies in the row of hexes the prow inhabited.





Kelch

2nd Rate, 20,000 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 10
 - **Hit Points** 500
 - **Rigging HP** 120
 - **Speed** 3
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
20	25	4/8	15

- **Max Crew** 40
 - **Storage** 4,000 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 6
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

Characteristics

- **Large Mast.** 2 Masts, with one counting as 2 for the purpose of Rigging HP (3 masts total).
- **Small Mast.** Beneath 33% Rigging HP, Rigging HP has an additional +2 AC.

Unrated Ships

Braque

Unrated, 10,000gp

-
- **Armor Class** 13
 - **Hit Points** 400
 - **Rigging HP** 40
 - **Speed** 3
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
------------------	--------------	----------------	---------------

15	25	3/4	5
----	----	-----	---

- **Max Crew** 15
 - **Storage** 3,200 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 2
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

- **Category Characteristics**
 - **Aerodynamic** Ignore penalties from sailing into wind
 - **Lightweight** Requires only +3 boarding bonus to avoid drifting in the absence of a check
 - **Improved Turning** The "Come About" maneuver instead rotates the ship 180 degrees. See "Movement" for more information.
-

Characteristics

- **Steady.** "Come About" does not automatically invoke overboard saves- a pilot check can be made to avoid them as normal.
-

Corvette

Unrated, 12,000gp

-
- **Armor Class** 13
 - **Hit Points** 400
 - **Rigging HP** 80
 - **Speed** 3
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
15	25	3/4	5

- **Max Crew** 15
 - **Storage** 3,200 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 2
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

- **Category Characteristics**
 - **Aerodynamic** Ignore penalties from sailing into wind
 - **Lightweight** Requires only +3 boarding bonus to avoid drifting in the absence of a check
 - **Improved Turning** The "Come About" maneuver instead rotates the ship 180 degrees. See "Movement" for more information.
-

Characteristics

- **Rigging.** Has 2 masts (+40 Rigging Hp)

- **Sleek** Advantage on "About Face" Pilot checks.
- **Top Heavy** The pilot gains Disadvantage on Piloting Saves as a result of BroadSides.
- **Crow's Nest.** Has 1 "Crow's Nest" Enhancement

Brigantine

Unrated, 10,000gp

-
- **Armor Class** 13
 - **Hit Points** 400
 - **Rigging HP** 40
 - **Speed** 3

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
15	25	3/4	5

-
- **Max Crew** 15
 - **Storage** 3,200 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 2
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison

-
- **Category Characteristics**
 - **Aerodynamic** Ignore penalties from sailing into wind
 - **Lightweight** Requires only +3 boarding bonus to avoid drifting in the absence of a check

- **Improved Turning** The "Come About" maneuver instead rotates the ship 180 degrees. See "Movement" for more information.

Characteristics

- **Manual.** Automatically Includes the Ship Enhancements: "Oars" and "Oar Ports"

Cutter

Unrated, 12,000gp

-
- **Armor Class** 13
 - **Hit Points** 400
 - **Rigging HP** 40
 - **Speed** 3

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
15	25	3/3	5

-
- **Max Crew** 15
 - **Storage** 3,200 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 2
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison

-
- **Category Characteristics**
 - **Aerodynamic** Ignore penalties from sailing into wind

- **Lightweight** Requires only +3 boarding bonus to avoid drifting in the absence of a check
- **Improved Turning** The "Come About" maneuver instead rotates the ship 180 degrees. See "Movement" for more information.

Characteristics

- **Steady.** "Come About" does not automatically invoke overboard saves- a pilot check can be made to avoid them as normal.
- **Limited Deck** Max 3 cannons to a side
- **Interceptor.** Travel Speed calculated as if the ship is 2nd rate.

Dhow

Unrated, 8,000gp

-
- **Armor Class** 13
 - **Hit Points** 400
 - **Rigging HP** 80
 - **Speed** 3

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
15	25	3/4	5

-
- **Max Crew** 15
 - **Storage** 3,200 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 2
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison

-
- **Category Characteristics**
 - **Aerodynamic** Ignore penalties from sailing into wind
 - **Lightweight** Requires only +3 boarding bonus to avoid drifting in the absence of a check
 - **Improved Turning** The "Come About" maneuver instead rotates the ship 180 degrees. See "Movement" for more information.
-

Characteristics

- **Lanteen Sails.** Triangular sails
 - **Large Mast.** 2 Masts (+40 Rigging HP).
 - **Small Mast.** Beneath 50% Rigging HP, Targeting Rigging HP has an additional -2 to hit.
-
-

Half - Galley

Unrated, 4,000gp

- **Armor Class** 13
 - **Hit Points** 400
 - **Rigging HP** 0
 - **Speed** 2 (Oar Power Only)
-

Damage Threshold	Effective HP	Cannon Min/Max	Skeleton Crew
15	25	3/4	5

- **Max Crew** 15
 - **Storage** 3,200 lbs.
 - **Davit Slots** 2
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

- **Category Characteristics**
 - ***Aerodynamic*** Ignore penalties from sailing into wind
 - ***Lightweight*** Requires only +3 boarding bonus to avoid drifting in the absence of a check
 - ***Improved Turning*** The "Come About" maneuver instead rotates the ship 180 degrees. See "Movement" for more information.
-

Characteristics

- ***Manual.*** Includes Ship Enhancements: "Oars" and "Oar Ports"
- ***All Manual*** Not able to install masts, sails, etc. No bonus or penalties from wind.





Small Craft

Rowboat

Small Craft, 50gp

-
- **Armor Class** 13
 - **Hit Points** 50
 - **Rigging HP** 0
 - **Speed** 1 (Oar Power Only)
-

Damage Threshold	Cannon Max	Skeleton Crew
0	0	1

- **Max Crew** 4
 - **Storage** 500 lbs.
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

- **Category Characteristics**
 - **Manual.** Includes Ship Enhancements: "Oars"
 - **All Manual.** No bonus or penalties from wind.
 - **Super Lightweight.** A +2 Boarding bonus is needed for this craft to be pulled alongside another. This does not act like a grapple, and the small craft is moved with its target.
-

Longboat

Small Craft, 200 gp

-
- **Armor Class** 15
 - **Hit Points** 150
 - **Rigging HP** 0
 - **Speed** 1
-

Damage Threshold	Cannon Max	Skeleton Crew
0	1	1

- **Max Crew** 8
 - **Storage** 500 lbs.
 - **Damage Immunities:** Psychic, Poison
-

- **Category Characteristics**
 - **Manual.** Includes Ship Enhancements: "Oars"
 - **All Manual.** No bonus or penalties from wind.
 - **Super Lightweight.** A +2 Boarding bonus is needed for this craft to be pulled alongside another. This does not act as a grapple, and the small craft is moved with its target.
-

Characteristics

- **Raise Sail.** Longboats May be upgraded with a single mast, to give an extra 1 speed. This causes the craft to lose the "All Manual" characteristic. This mast cannot support any further enhancements.
- **Small Siege Weapon.** The siege weapon slot may only be used for a Ballista or Carronade.

DM Tools

I see this section as a chance to speak a bit more informally to you, the DM, to help you use this guide and give you some personal suggestions.

General Tips:

- Give more gold than usual
- While most of the rules are based around travel and Naval Combat, that shouldn't always be the focus; the destinations are.
- Keep Unskilled/skilled hirelings differentiated. Letting players promote unskilled hirelings to officer roles could have consequences on the balance of the game, particularly around boarding.
- How to get players a ship:
 - Steal
 - Inherit
 - Emergency on the sea (captain dies)
 - Earn it after capturing it with others
 - Already own
- Cannons are very deadly. Treat them like dangerous monsters. Don't introduce the best ones too early the same way you wouldn't throw a dragon at the party.
- Players will always "trade up", so don't present anything you don't expect them to take
 - Consider rolling to see how much of the ship is recoverable or develop a point-based capture system.
- Let players feel secure about leaving their ship on a dock, anchored off shore, etc. No one wants to feel like their coolest possession could be stolen while they sleep. A guard presence, dockworkers, or a harbor master to leave a paper trail with all do well in promoting confidence. If it may be a bad idea to leave the ship for extended time, make this clear to players.
 - At the same time, the ship being stolen can be a powerful hook, but this should be an exception and used with care.

- The longer a trip, the less encounter dense it should be. Require fewer perception checks the longer a trip is, down to one a day, weighing random events in a similar fashion.

How To build Naval Combat

Unfortunately, it is hard to assign levels or CR to ships the way we can monsters. This makes understanding how two ships compare much harder - compounded with unforgiving nature of Naval Combat. An unbalanced battle is harder to make up for, and escape from, than standard combat.

Since ships can be understood by the parts that make them, I use gold as my current balancing tool. Gold accounts for the size of the ship, it's potential for weapons, the crew it has hired, the weapons it has purchased and any upgrades it has. Theoretically, I consider a "Functional Gold Value" for both my parties and enemies ships, a value that ignores any non-combat investments.

Evenly matched ships have functional values of within 5,000 gp. By the time you reach a difference of around 10,000 gp, one ship has a nearly insurmountable advantage. To determine values of ships, I use a **Ship Calculator** Excel sheet which is linked in the subreddit [r/5eNavalCampaigns](#).

Using the calculator, I build a ship of the gold value I want, and then transfer the stats onto the "[Naval Combat Management](#)" sheet I have supplied at the end of this guide.

For starters, I would run your party against a ship of roughly -8,000 gp while they learn the ropes. After that, I would continue to keep enemies at a deficit for a time until you become more comfortable with the system - this has the added bonus of not accidentally giving your players a ship or upgrades you didn't intend.

Unfortunately, the gold value method is imperfect, especially at the extremes. An unrated ship with fully upgraded weapons will easily defeat a 1st class ship without any weapons. To a finer degree, different upgrades may be more effective in a specific situation despite having similar prices, something that can't always be accounted for. Basically, take time and get comfortable with this yourself. I will continue to try and improve this aspect of play.

How to run naval Combat

Naval Combat introduces a lot of new rules and interactive aspects. While this is fun for players, this can bog down an already busy DM. Here are my tips for streamlining things on your end. I often run using these shortcuts:

- Use the average damage for each cannon instead of rolling

- Track how many of each type of cannon you have, and fire either half or all of each type on a turn, not a specific number
- For BroadSides, add +1 damage for every hit, instead of the exploding dice.
- To simplify casualties rolls on enemy ships, assume 1 casualty for every 2 hits a ship takes.

Naval Combat Tips:

- Fights should usually end before a ship is sinking
 - Most Naval Battles end in boarding because the players are most confident on land and in standard combat - they excel there so it's okay.
- In Naval Combat, Players have less agency, and comebacks are less possible. Introducing too big of a ship will kill the party
 - If your party wishes to disengage, try to let them. In my experiences, Naval Combat is given to death spirals, and so if one ship takes the lead the outlook can be bleak for the other.
 - In the same vein, have contingency plans for if the party's ship is sunk or they are taken captive. This is pretty likely, and you don't want to be caught off guard.
- Ship battles are long, I wouldn't use evenly matched ones as random encounters, only planned
 - A multi-ship battle can easily take up an entire session.

Quick Ships

Crew does not include Combat Units, which should be balanced separately. The skilled Hireling is generally the Pilot- no cannoneers are needed on NPC ships.

Gold Value	Ship	Cannons (per side)	Enhancements	Cannon Upgrades	Crew (unskilled/skilled)	Shot
10k	Dhow	x2 Ballista	Crow's Nest Davit x1 Lifeboat	-	10/1	-
15k	Dhow	x4 Ballista	Crow's Nest Reinforced Walls	-	10/1	-
20k	Braque	x4 Ballista	Crow's Nest Reinforced Walls Fireproof Deck	Ease of Access (x1)	10/1	x2 Ballista Harpoons
30k	Braque	x4 Light	Crow's Nest Reinforced Walls Fireproof Deck Ram	-	10/1	x1 Cannon Harpoon
35k	Schooner	x4 L x2 M	Crow's Nest Fireproof Deck Ram	Packed (x2 of Med)	25/3	-
38k	Schooner	x4 L x2 H x2 Ca x2 Ballista	Fireproof Deck	Packed (All Light)	25/5	x2 Explosive
40k	Kelch	x2 L x2 M x2 H	Crow's Nest Arcanists Shield Fireproof Deck	Packed (All M)	30/2	x2 Boring x1 Explosive Flares
48k	Kelch	x4 L x2 M x2 H	Crow's Nest Arcanist's Shield Fireproof Deck Reinforced Hull	Packed (All M)	30/4	x2 Explosive x2 Grapeshot x1 Smoke

Gold Value	Ship	Cannons (per side)	Enhancements	Cannon Upgrades	Crew (unskilled/skilled)	Shot
60k	Clipper	x4 L x4 M x2 H	Crow's Nest Fireproof Hull	Precision (2, H)	35/5	-
85k	Merchant	x5 L x4 M x4 H	Crow's Arcanist's Shield Improved - Mechanism Fireproof (all)	Precision (2) and Rifling (2)	80/5	x2 Chain x2 Explosive x2 Grapeshot

Tiers of Rules:

As a shortcut to deciding which rules to use, I have defined different tiers of rules. Each tier adds more complexity and realism to the game.

These groupings are suggestions. Mix and match to find the things in which you are most interested!

Just Ships, Please

These rules are written so that you can skip all the fluff- just add the Ships with some Cannons to your game for a quick session on the high seas. For a more memorable time, it is recommended to at least move up to "Captain Hook". Officers and their actions are the backbone of Naval Combat.

Captain Hook

Simple, straightforward play. Also see 'The Naval Code: Abridged'

Add

Captain Hook is meant for groups that don't want to learn too many new mechanics and want to avoid looking up results on tables. It adds a few rules to streamline the game:

Travel Roles

Instead of linking different toles of traveling to each Officer Position, you may instead allow for anyone to undertake any available role. This is a simpler and more forgiving method. ([p.12](#))

Alternate Overboard Save Rules

These rules are offered in the section to avoid referencing the tables as much. They require fewer rolls and offer predictable results. ([p. 26](#))

Ignore

Many more rules are ignored than added. To streamline the rules and focus more on the game, the following non-essential rules can be dropped:

- **Skeleton Crew**
 - Ships do not require Skeleton crew, or require half the normal amount
- Don't give crew **stats** or an **income**- they are just background characters.
- **Wind Effects**
 - Going against it incurs no penalty, and no bonus is given for sailing with it.
- **No weather conditions**
- **Half Field of Fire**
 - Instead, the entire area is the Full Field. To simplify further, remove the field of fire entirely - A cannon may fire on a target if it is on the same side of the ship as it. Range rules still apply.
- **Spell Rules**
 - Spells act the same on sea as on land. Easier to remember, but far less balanced.
- **Casualties**
 - Assume Crew never dies in combat

Pirates of the Caribbean

The “intended” version: A classic DND balance of challenges, with room for debauchery. The Naval Code is built for this level, so no additions or subtractions are needed.

Documentary

A realistic, less forgiving and resource considering variant.

Sometimes, it is fun to track everything about the ship. How are the rations? Do we have black powder? Are the crew pacified? The following rules add more detailed rules for a more realistic experience.

Add

Crew in Combat Rules

Some of your crew must continue sailing the ship instead of manning cannons. [\(p.6\)](#)

Payment Model

A more realistic and expensive model. [\(p.13\)](#)

Black Powder and Cannon Shot

Cannons require both the proper sized cannon ball as well as the proper amount of black powder. If these get ruined or run out, you will not be able to fire those cannons. [\(p. 13\)](#)

Direct Wind Facing Penalty

You may not sail directly into the wind, and anywhere upwind is difficult terrain. More realistic, and invites greater strategy. [\(p.25\)](#)

Alt Medicine DC

A harder DC so fewer casualties are recovered after battle.
[\(p.30\)](#)

Tattoos:

Official Navy/ Decent

Earned

-
- **Fully-Rigged Ship**- Sailed through torrential Waters of _____ (Dangerous Pass)

-
- **Nautical Star**: Acted as Navigator for a successful venture: Symbolizes ability to find their way home

-
- **Turtle**: Crossing the southern tip of the mainland

-
- **Swallow**: One for every 5,754 miles sailed.
-

- **Anchor:** Crossed the _____ (Large Ocean or Sea- New World side)
-

- **Hula Girl:** Been to the _____ (Tropical Vacation Destination)

Superstition

- **HOLD and FAST on fingers:** Luck Charm for holding ropes
-

- **SOME KIND OF BEAST:** To float
-

- **Compass Rose:** Luck in finding home
-

- **Nature Deity's symbol** (on foot): Ward off sharks, etc.

Brands:

- _____ **Crest** (on Neck): (Criminal)
-

- **Dotted Line on Wrist:** Prison
-

- **Black Circle:** Mark of shame- attempted mutiny

ID

- **Crossed Cannons:** Military service as a sailor or a ships Master Gunner
-

- **Crossed Anchors** (on finger webbing) = boatswain
-

- **Dragon:** Served in _____ (Major Naval City)

-
- **Golden Dragon:** Sailed from _____ to _____ (Both large cities, classically opposite sides of country. One city generally associated with the Dragon tattoo)
-

- **Harpoon:** Has landed or served in a beast-hunting ship
-

- **Dagger through Swallow:** Lost comrade who earned a swallow together.
-

- **Rope on Wrist:** Identifies as a deckhand
-

- **Rune on back of hand** (or less obvious location): Arcanist for ships
-

- **Oblong circle with wave inside:** Knows “Water breathing”

Non-Official

Bragging Rights

-
- **Dragon Eye:** Seen a Dragon
-

- **Tentacle Around Ankle:** Has been pulled off a ship
-

- **Lips on neck:** Siren
-

- **Halo:** Resurrected

Branding:

-
- **Swirl with a slash:** Forced pirate service, used to keep them loyal as they are unemployable

Identification

-
- **Fey Pyramid:** Has fey ancestry
-

- **Blood drop on hand:** Healer
-

Self-Expressive:

-
- **Dagger in Rose:** Will fight anything
-

- **Dice:** Risky
-

- **7-point star:** Optimist
-

- **Pin Up:** No universal meaning - that's personal business.
-

Indecent/Pirate

-
- **Mermaid:** A “conquest” w/ a mermaid
-

- **A Black Circle:** Mark of shame- attempted mutiny
-

- **Black Bar on Wrist:** Prison Time, one for each sentence
-

- **Two Coins:** Favor of the _____ House (Organized Crime)
-

- **Arrow toward Hand:** Always looking for more

-
- **Teardrop shaped Heart:** A lover back on shore (likely a prostitute)
-

- **Chain Around Arm:** “Chain Breaker”; escaped capture by the law or freed another





Nautical Terms

Ahead

- Refers to moving forward.

Aft

- The rearward direction or portion of a ship.

Astern

- Refers to a boat moving in a backwards position (reverse).

Amidships

- The ship's center.

Ballast

- Weight placed in the lower middle of a ship to help keep it steady in water.

Beam

- The width of the ship, measured at its widest point, typically around midship.

Bilge

- The broadest part of the hold at the bottom of a ship. Pumps are often placed here to evacuate water from leaky vessels.

Belaying pin

- Short wooden rod used to secure rigging and a common improvised club-like weapon.

Boom

-
- A long spar extending from a mast to hold or extend the foot of a sail.

Bow

-
- The forward end of a ship

Come about

-
- Changing the direction of a ship.

Cordage

-
- The ropes in the rigging of a ship.

Crow's nest

-
- Small platform at the top of a mast used to get a better view when watching for approaching sails, monsters or land.

Draft

-
- The minimum depth of water to float a ship. A ship with a 5-foot draft requires at least 5 feet of water to float and will run aground in water with a depth of less than 5 feet.

Disembark

-
- To have left a ship

Forecastle

-
- Raised deck at the foremost of a ship. Not nearly as tall as the Stern castle, Uncommon except in the largest of ships. May house sailors living quarters or

provide entry to lower decks. The deck acts as a vantage point while the interior may function as a defensive stronghold.

Forward or Fore

- The forward direction or portion of a ship toward the bow.

Forecastle

- Upper deck of a ship forward of the foremast where non-officer living quarters were usually found.

Heave to

- To come to a halt.

Heel

- Tilting of a ship over to one side due to the wind or seas.

Helm

- The steering wheel of a ship which controls the rudder.

Hold

- A large area for storing cargo in the lower part of a ship.

Hull

- The frame or body of a ship. It is the hollow, lowermost portion, floating partially submerged and supporting the remainder of the ship.

Jacob's ladder

- A rope ladder with wooden rungs used to access a ship from the side.

Keel

- The underside of a ship. Keelhauling refers to dragging a person under a ship, across the barnacle laden keel .

Knots

- The measure of a ship's speed in nautical miles per hour. One nautical mile is equal to 1.15 miles or 6080 feet.

Leeward

- The side away from the direction from which the wind blows.

Length

- The overall length of the ship, as measured from bow to stern.

List

- A ship leaning to one side due to shifted cargo or taking on water.

Mast

- A mast is a large vertical pole upon which the ship's sails hang. The large one in the central is the mainmast, the rear-most is the mizzen.

Mizzenmast

- The largest and perhaps most important mast. It is the third mast or the mast aft of a mainmast on a ship having three or more masts.

Orlop deck

-
- The lowest deck in a ship with 3.

Poop deck

-
- Highest deck at the stern of a large ship, usually above the captain's quarters.
Location of the wheel.

Port

-
- The left hand side of the ship when facing forward.

Prow

-
- Forward-most part of a ship's bow that cuts through the water.

Quarterdeck

-
- Raised deck behind the main mast of a sailing ship

Raking Fire

-
- Cannon fire that runs longways down a ship, as opposed to across it from the side.
Causes great destruction and has potential to travel down the decks.

Rigging

-
- System of ropes used to support and move the sails. Often used to describe the entire system of masts, sails and ropes (or cordage) used for sailing.

Rudder

-
- A flat piece of wood, hinged vertically near the stern of a boat or ship for steering, controlled by a tiller or wheel.

Running

- To sail with the wind.

Sail

- A sail is a surface, typically made of fabric and supported by a mast, whose purpose is to propel a sailing vessel.

Square: A rectangular sail hung from a single yard. The simplest and oldest form of rigging which permitted sailing only before the wind.

Lanteen: A triangular sail set on a long yard mounted at an angle on the mast. Capable of taking the wind on either side.

Jib: A triangular headsail that sets ahead of the foremast of a ship, mainly used to increase performance and overall stability by reducing turbulence.

Sinking:

- **Overwhelmed:** Sinks because it cannot deal with the force of waves. An overwhelmed ship becomes swamped, or has water coming in over the deck. An overwhelmed ship that sinks deck up has "foundered," while an overwhelmed ship that sinks on its side or with its hull up has "capsized".
- **Break Deep:** Damage occurs to the ship below the water line. Often, a ship that breaks deep sinks when water rushes into the break and fills the ship. When this occurs, the ship is said to "take water."
- **Scuttle:** To "scuttle" a ship is to sink the ship deliberately.
- **Split Up:** Particularly long ships are vulnerable to "splitting up" when the waves are high. A ship splits up when its bow ends up on the crest of one wave, while the stern ends up on the crest of the wave immediately behind it. The center of the ship is lifted out of the water and, with no support, splits in half, breaking the ship into two pieces.

Speed

- The base sailing speed in light winds of the ship.

Starboard

- The right side of a ship when facing forward.

Stern

- The aft end of a ship.

Stern castle (After castle, Aft castle)

- The structure on the stern which often houses the captain's cabin, upon which the poop deck and wheel sits.

Tacking

- Changing a ship's course by angling into the wind.

Topside

- Moving from a lower deck of a boat to an upper deck.

Underway

- When a boat is moving, either by motor or wind, this is called being "underway."

Velocity

- The current speed a ship is traveling, measured in feet per round.

Waist

- Central deck of a ship that is found between the forecastle and the quarterdeck.

Yard

-
- A horizontal pole on which a sail is hung.

Yardarm

- The main arm across the mast which holds up the sail. or enemies

Integrating Other Homebrew

Below is a list of recommended / optional house rules or Homebrew guides, along with an explanation as to why I used them or believe they could be used. Highly tested and recommended, those which I think to be essential to the experience, are marked with the "**Natural 20**". You could say they are *critical* in my opinion. Ha.

Alternate Rests

Since traveling by ship results in lots of downtime, I highly recommend using the alternate rest rules from the DMG. Personally, I use Long Rest = 2 days of light or downtime activity, while Short Rests remain 1 hour. Sleep is still required every 36 hours or else exhaustion may take effect.

I do this to better fill the time on ship, let officers make meaningful choices about what traveling roles they take, and make the actual adventure more dramatic - the players may feel the relief of landing at port for a few nights rest. I find that with a naval campaign, this rest system helps pace it the way I want.

Evolving Cantrips, by u/Craios125

In light of a more punishing rest system, I wanted to help my Long Rest gated casters just a bit. Integrating evolving cantrips meant that in lieu of spell slots, they still felt like they had things to offer around the ship.

Mathew Mercer's Gunslinger

In a guide which introduces firearms, it would be a disservice not to mention the Gunslinger Archetype for Fighters, created by Matthew Mercer. This is, in my opinion, the best choice for a gun using PC, and I built some of the rules of the game with this subclass in mind, such as the Misfire rules for cannons.

I would like to recognize that the guns offered in this guide (listed in the "Gear" section) differ from his own stats, and in my game I use both. The Gunslinger should have the best weapons. "Common" guns, those in this guide, are more expensive and less effective than

those the gunslinger creates- I let them upgrade normal firearms into their Gunslinger versions for for a fraction of the price. This is to help differentiate a gunslinger from anyone else with a gun, while still allowing other players and NPC's to access firearms.

Darker Dungeons, by u/giffglyph

The following aspects of this homebrew I use (or have used) in naval campaigns:

-
- **Traveling Roles:** As mentioned in the section, I derived my traveling system completely from this homebrew, adding a roles as needed for the ship.
-
- **Inventory:** I am a great fan of the inventory “slot” system introduced here. In a game where the players travel on their storage container, and thus have easy access to any item they please, I wanted them to have to make a choice as to what they were bringing with them when they made landfall - and also make choices as to what to do with large amounts of treasure when they find it (who would bury it when you can carry all of it at once?)
-
- I also found the vast size of ships to be difficult to quantify storage. In the end, I would recommend either ignoring the storage aspect of this ship or using the slot system as described in Darker Dungeons, as it is much more manageable. The conversion for ships below:
 - **1st Rate:** 120 slots
 - **2nd Rate:** 80 Slots
 - **Unrated:** 64 Slots
 - **Treasure Chests:** 3 slots
 - **Officer Lockboxes:** 6 Slots
 - **Lockers:** 2 slots
-
- **Notches:** A great way to implement weapon and armor wear. In a game of long journeys, this can have interesting effects.

Fortresses, Temples, & Strongholds (v4), by Warlock

This guide presents rooms you may build in strongholds which bestow benefits. I really liked the idea of allowing players to build these expansions on their ships to make them a personalized floating fort. Due to the economy surrounding ships, I doubled the prices as listed. I also recommend "**Traders and Merchants**" by the same user for populating harbors.

The Expansion Slots of ships are as follows:

1st Rate: 3

2nd Rate: 2

Unrated: 1

Carrack: Includes "War Room" for free (no expansion slot used)

East Indiaman: Includes "Lodgings" room for free

Galleon: Includes "Barracks" for free

Guineaman: Extra Expansion slot available (4 total)

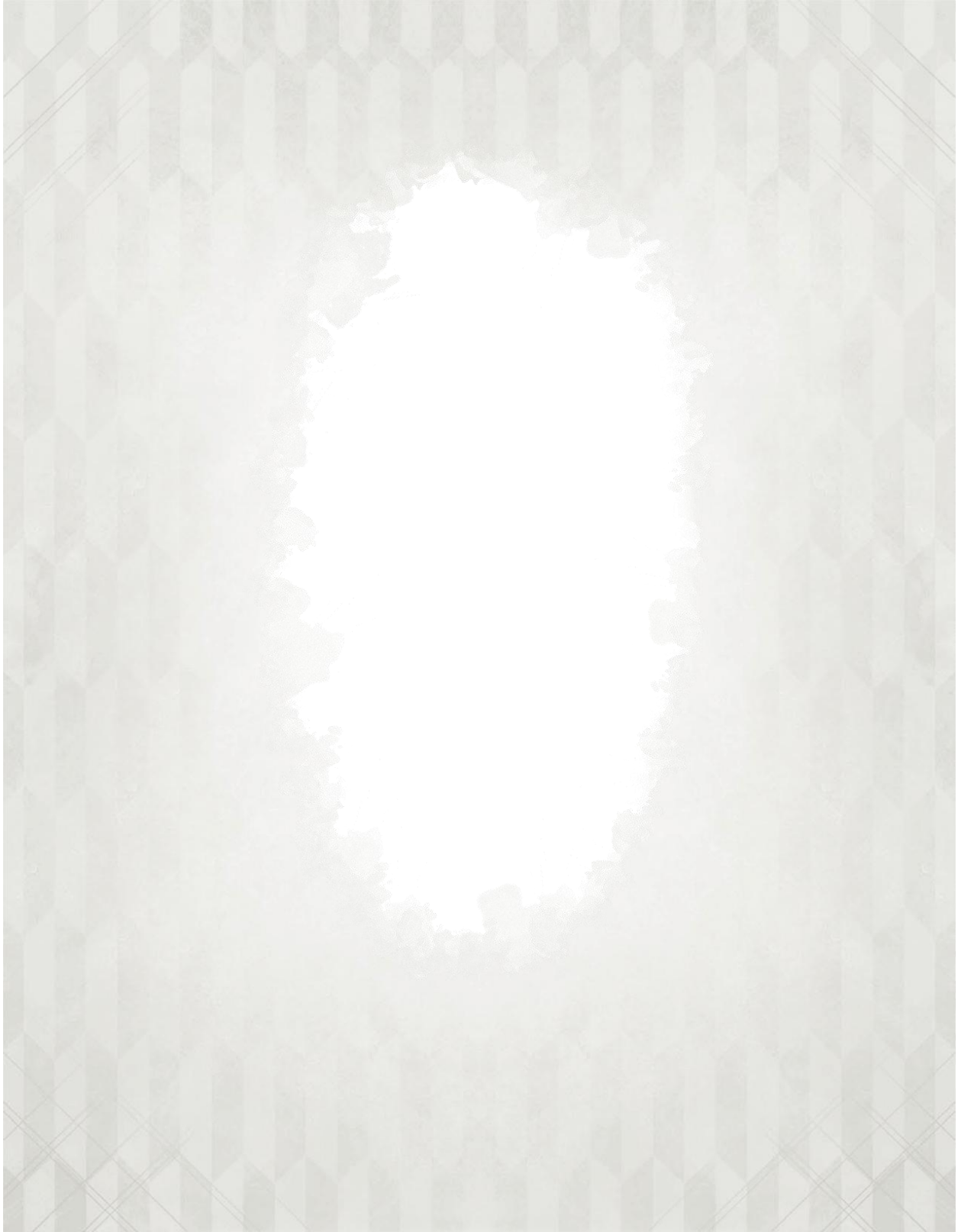
Galley: Extra Expansion Slot Available (3 total)





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Thanks & Credits

To the Following Characters (and their Players)

-
- **Rhys & Rhys**

-
- **Kyrrhos & Aria**

-
- **Daisy & Cyrano**

-
- **Aetiesh & Sanders McFlanders**

-
- **Solveigh**

A special thanks to the following people:

-
- **u/giffglyph** (Travel Roles)

-
- **Shawn Ellsworth of Tribality** (Original Inspiration, Inspiration for Officers, Officer Actions, Backgrounds)

-
- **Matthew Mercer** (Firearm Properties)

Other Influences:

-
- Pirates of the Caribbean
 - Treasure Island
 - Conquest- Pirate Weapons
 - Uncharted Waters Online
 - AC IV Black-Flag

- Akella Games (Pirates of Caribbean, Age of Pirates)
- Pillars of Eternity II

Art Credits

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 - (P. 33)**Daryl Mandryk** (Source: Richard Pett. (2012). The Wormwood Mutiny. The Wormwood Mutiny, p. 3. Paizo Publishing, LLC. ISBN 978-1-60125-404-7, retrieved from Pathfinderwiki.com, released as a part of *Piazo's Community Use Package*)
 - (P. 35) **Robson Michel** "New Skies Ahead!" (retrieved from <https://www.artstation.com/robmichel>)
 - (P. 39) **Reha Sakar** "Pirates" (2014), Retrieved from <https://www.artstation.com/reha>
 - (P. 42)**Robert D. Brown** (retrieved from <http://robertdbrown.com/#robert-brown>)

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- (P. 46) **Florian Stitz** "**Black Powder Sage**" (from the Pathfinder RPG Villain Codex, retrieved from <https://www.artstation.com/artwork/DOyLO>)
- (P. 48) **Gregory Manchess**, "**Pirate Paintings for National Geographic Pt. 4 (2011)**" (retrieved from <http://teamcolors.blogspot.com/2011/09/pirate-paintings-for-national.html>)
- (P. 49)- **Bram Sels** (retrieved from <https://www.artstation.com/bramsels>)





Changelog

v0.1 - 0.2

- Ran with minimal rules

v0.3

- Too much to count
- Converted to GM Binder
- Cover Cannon aim
- Overboard saves and Magic Section

v0.4

- Added Travel Speeds
- Moved and Renamed Individual / Crew spell based overboard saves
- Adjusted Naval Combat Speed
- Adjusted Shot Pricing
- Changed Officer Casualties to on-crit
- Added Officer Location section
- Added Militant Officer
- Expanded Sailor Backgrounds
- Adjusted Boon
- Added Quick ship builds
- Clarifications to Pilot Checks
- Redid Ship table as Statblocks

v0.5

- Clarified Gear Terminology
- Added several enhancements
- Adjusted cannon-upgrade prices
- Added Images throughout
- Cleaned "Shot" table

- Clarification in Officer Locations
- Clarifications in Magic section
- General spelling and grammar

v0.6

- Massive Re-organization
- Combined Officer and Travel roles
- Separated Captain, First Mate and Quartermaster
- Formatted Cannon tables
- Cannon Template Aim mechanics
- Nerfed Costs again
- Fixed Crab walking ships, supported ship drifting
- Removed Redundant Feat, Firearm Expert Feat Added
- Added Firearm property, rebalanced firearms
- Gave Cannons load time (differentiated from reload)
- Cast off times
- Began DM Tips
- Gave Corsair proficiency in firearms
- Siege Weapons now deal double damage to shops (As in RAW)
 - Adjusted Siege Damage and Ship HP to compensate
- Added Casualty Damage trackers to ship / encounter sheets
- Added travel Role Reference Sheet
- Added DM Reference sheets: Includes Casualty rolls, overboard saves, cannon ranges and damage, and more!
- Adjusted Bayonet use
- Clarified Asses Action
- Combined Gear and Items

- Included Crow's nests in some ships
- Spelling and Grammar

v1.0

- Added Raking Fire
- Updated Cannon Range Mechanics & Adjusted to compensate
 - Nerfed Mobility and AC of Unrated Ships
- Added Magic + Movement rules
- Added restraints to the "Order Repair" Action
- Major Boarding Rework
- Simpler, more in line with 5e's design philosophy
- Distributed rules to proper locations (e.g., Grappling hook benefit and mechanics are now in the item description)
- Rules for being Overboard
 - Small Craft Rules

- Pilot check QoL update
 - No disadvantage if BA is taken before other actions for logistical reasons.
- Added "Using this Guide" section and cleaned the introduction
- Reworked Travel Speeds
 - Larger ships now travel faster than their less powerful counterparts
- Naval Code: Abridged
- Renamed "Effective HP"
 - Reworked penalty
- Added "Rotating Turret" Upgrade, "Reinforced Walls", renamed "Live Oak Hull"
 - Tuned some others
- Nerfed prices again (massively increased ironside price)
- Increased DM tips, including:
 - How to Build Naval Combat
 - How to run Naval Combat
- Updated all printable materials to reflect changes
- Reorganization
- Removed Playtest Foreword
- Codified rope swings, grappling hooks and harpoons
- Renamed "Zones" to "Field of Fire"
- Small Individual Ship adjustments
- Casualty Adjustment, Major Officer and Crewless casualty Revision
- Clarifications to Magic Rules
- Spelling & Grammar







CREW



Name: _____	Skills/Notes:	Pay: 
Appearance:	Assignment:	
Classification:		

Name: _____	Skills/Notes:	Pay: 
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Classification:		

Name: _____	Skills/Notes:	Pay: 
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CREW (DM)

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Appearance:		Notes:							
Voice:	Assignment:								



Encounter Name

Difficulty

XP Value

Location

Wind Direction

Weather Conditions

25 _____
24 _____
23 _____
22 _____
21 _____
20 _____
19 _____
18 _____
17 _____
16 _____
15 _____
14 _____
13 _____
12 _____
11 _____
10 _____
9 _____
8 _____
7 _____
6 _____
5 _____
4 _____
3 _____
2 _____
1 _____
0 _____

RIGGING HP: /

Max:

Minimum Functional HP:

Current Hit Points

Features:

Armor
Class

Threshold

Speed

Crew: /

Skeleton:

Round 1 Round 2 Round 3 Round 4 Round 5

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Round 6 Round 7 Round 8 Round 9 Round 10

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Casualty Damage

Boarding Bonuses

Arcanists/Militants

SPECIAL SHOTS:

Name _____

Amount

Restrictions/Effect

Name

Amount

Restrictions/Effect

Available Gunners:

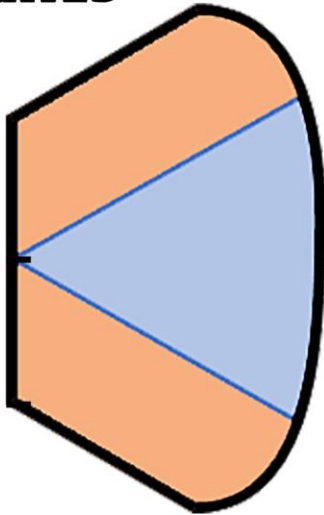
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STARBOARD

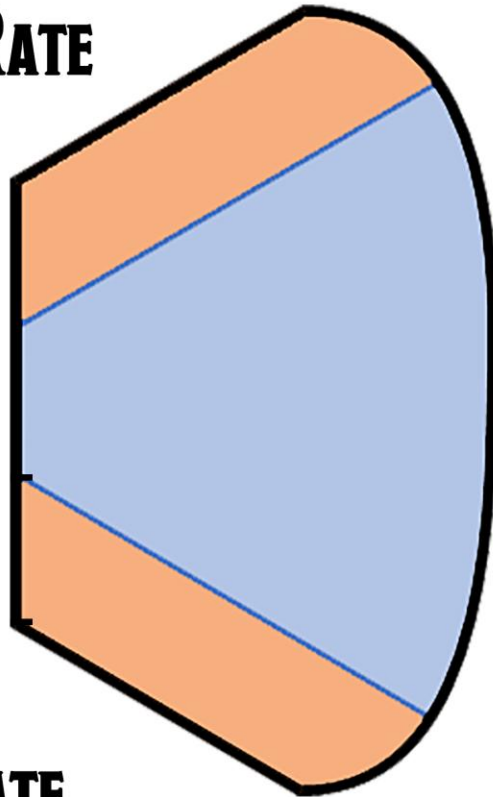
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Field of Fire Templates

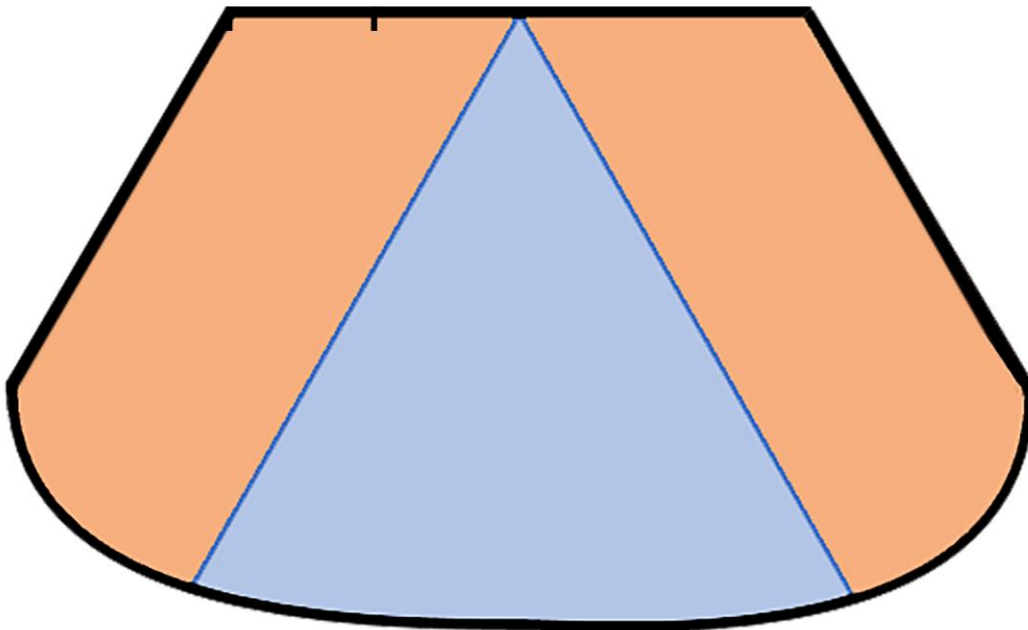
UNRATED



2ND RATE



1ST RATE



TRAVEL ROLE REFERENCE SHEET

Below are the outlines to each responsibility while traveling on a ship. Each Officer may choose one responsibility out of those available to them to fulfill each day or choose to assist another.

CARPENTER (BOATSWAIN)

- For each of the day (5 total) in which you did not spend time doing anything else (combat, other actions, adventure, etc.), make a Carpenter's tools check (DC: 15). On 3 passes, you may add 2d6 x your proficiency bonus HP back to the ship. You may split this between Ship and Rigging HP as you see fit.

COOK (QUARTERMASTER)

- After a full day of having a cook, anyone who ate may spend one free hit die on their next short rest. Benefit fades at the end of the day following.
- Less likely for disease to spread and higher morale

LOOKOUT (ARCANIST / MILITANT)

- Responsible for making Perception checks to notice landmarks, obstacles, encounters, etc. If you have a lookout at the start of a Naval Encounter, the ship gains a +1 to their initiative (even if the lookout missed the threat)

NAVIGATOR (CAPTAIN)

- Make a Nature / Survival check at each part of the day (5 total), against the same DC as the Pilot's checks. Each success by the Navigator gives a +1 to the Pilot's survival check at the same point of time.
- Once the Navigator fails 2 checks, they are unable to give bonuses for the rest of the day (but cannot switch their role).

PILOT (HELMSMAN)

Responsible for making the Best of 5 Survival / Nature skill check a day to plan and execute a course. Anything that gives bonuses to navigation checks has the same effect on these rolls.

- Best of 5 Pilot Skill checks throughout the day.
 - If more successes than the DC (Base DC: 2), then subtract 1 day of travel. If fail, subtract ½ day from the trip.
- Checks are made with disadvantage if the pilot is not proficient in Vehicles (Water)

SURGEON (SURGEON)

Spend your day treating the wounded or sick. Requires proficiency in Medicine or related tool.

- On a successful medicine check, 1d4 people may gain the effects of a Lesser Restoration Spell.

ASSIST

- Any player may Assist another role, granting a +1 to rolls. Other benefits, as well as requirements, may apply per the assisted role.

DM REFERENCE SHEET - NAVAL COMBAT

SIEGE WEAPON RANGE (HEXES)		
Source	Range Adv. / Norm / Max	Avg. Damage
Ballista	1 / 9 / 20	11
Catapult	2 / 13 / 24	11
Carronade	1 / 5 / 11	9
L Cannon	4 / 16 / 29	11
M Cannon	4 / 11 / 22	18
H Cannon	2 / 5 / 9	35
Culverin	0 / 28	18

OVERBOARD SAVE - NAVAL COMBAT	
Result	Effect
Success by 5+	Success + Advantage to Another
Success	Success
Failure by ≤ 9	Disadvantage Next Turn
Failure by 10+	Make a secondary Dex save, DC = to the last. - On a failure, fall overboard. - On a success, you may choose to stay on by giving another disadvantage. You cannot take an action next round

DISPLACEMENT EFFECT SAVE - NAVAL COMBAT	
Result	Effect
Success by 5+	Success + Advantage to Another
Success	Success
Failure by ≤ 4	In place of normal effects, Any action you take next turn has disadvantage as you scramble back in place.
Failure by 5+	Make a secondary Dex save, same DC On a success, you may choose to stay on by giving another disadvantage- you may take no action next round. On a failure, you fall overboard.

CASUALTY ROLL		
- Officer Casualty: On Crit, Dmg = Level		
- Crewless Casualty: Roll 1d6, if lower than tier, Officer Casualty		
Tier	Damage	Casualties
0	<30 damage	No Casualties
1	30 - 39	1 Casualty
2	40 - 69	1d4-1 (min 1)
3	70 - 119	1d4 (min 1)
4	120 - 159	1d4+1
5	160 - 199	1d4+2
6	≥200	1d4+3

OVERBOARD SAVE - CREW CHART	
Result	Effect
Success by 5+	All Save
Success	1d4-1 unskilled may not be used next round
Failure by ≤ 7	1d4 - 1 unskilled may not be used next round. One of those 1 falls overboard
Failure by 8+	1d4-1 Crew Fall overboard. On a roll of 1, one of them is a skilled hireling

DISPLACEMENT EFFECT SAVE - CREW CHART (+1 to roll for every Skilled Crew affected)	
Result	Effect
Success by 5+	All Save
Successes	All Skilled save, half affected unskilled may not be utilized next round
Failure by ≤ 7	All Skilled Save, and 3 out of 4 unskilled may not be used next round Additionally, 1 which fell prone instead falls overboard
Failure by 8+	2 out of 3 affected unskilled crew fall overboard. Affected Skilled Crew role on the "Individual" chart at disadvantage.

DM REFERENCE SHEET - GENERAL USE & STANDARD COMBAT

OVERBOARD SAVE - STANDARD COMBAT	
Result	Effect
Success	Success
Failure by 9 or less	Move 5 feet in appropriate direction. If this moves you off land, Move to the edge and fall prone.
Failure by 10 +	Move 15 feet in appropriate direction. If this moves you off the ground you are standing on, Dex save (DC= to original) - Success, fall prone at the edge. - Failure, fall overboard

DISPLACEMENT EFFECT SAVE - STANDARD COMBAT	
Result	Effect
Success	Success
Failure by 4 or less	Follow the directions of the effect. If this moves you off land, stop moving at the edge of the furthest point of land and fall prone instead
Failure by 5+	Follow the full, normal directions of the effect

CASUALTY RECOVERY ROLL DC: 8 + Number of Casualties	
Roll	Result
Success by 10 +	All live, incapacitated for 2 hours.
Success	All Live, incapacitated for 6 hours, 1 lvl of exhaustion.
Failure by 9 or less	Every Number below DC, One fail (Max 5). Survivors incapacitated 18 hours, 2 pt. exhaustion.
Failure by 10+	No survivors. All involved take 1 lvl of exhaustion.

RIGGING HP CHART	
HP Remaining	Conditions
51% or More	Full Effectiveness
50% - 26%	No bonus with wind
25% - 11%	No bonus or penalties from wind ½ Speed., ½ Travel Speed
10% or Lower	No bonus or penalties from wind. Speed and Travel Speed: 1 Hex

SPELL EFFECT ON MOVEMENT Must target over half of the masts on a ship	
2 nd level +	Favorable Wind Bonus
3 rd +	Speed +1, no strong wind condition
5 th +	No Penalty against wind, travel speed +1
7 th +	No mast requirement

TRAVEL SPEEDS			
Ship	Slow Pace	Normal Pace	Fast Pace
1st Rate	4	7	9
2nd Rate	4	6	8
Unrated	4	5	7
Small Craft	1	2	3

OTHER REFERENCES:

- Effective HP: Divs. on Officer Actions, Disadvantage on Siege Weapon Attacks,
- Favorable Wind: +1 Speed
- Making A Journey: Decide Location, define distance (days). Each Day, Best of 5 Survival check from helmsman. Base DC: 2
- Night Shift: Pilot Check DC:5 each watch.
- Ram: 1d12 per hex moved that round (Max 10, Min. 2)
- Raking Fire: Extra Weapon Damage Die when outside target's fields of fire
- Sinking: 1d6+2 rounds until submerged